

The Great Gatsby

F. Scott Fitzgerald · 1925

Standard Ebooks edition, produced from the Faded Page transcription (British spellings such as 'neighbour' and 'Coloured')

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

9 chapter lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 14 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 3 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
Cover: Pierre-Auguste Renoir, Luncheon of the Boating Party (1880–1881). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–9), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: The Great Gatsby was first published by Charles Scribner's Sons on 10 April 1925 and entered the U.S. public domain on 1 January 2021. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition (CC0), produced from the Faded Page transcription; it uses British spellings, so it does not reproduce the 1925 Scribner text letter for letter. Which printing the transcription follows has not been verified. Cite chapter and paragraph from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Heavy drinking and drunk driving, adultery, domestic violence, a fatal car crash, a murder and a suicide. Racist and antisemitic content appears in Tom's speeches (Ch I, VII), the narration itself (Ch IV, IX) and a character's slur (Ch II); do not read slurs aloud. See the chapter notes and the 988 safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 3. **Class days:** 14 × 90 minutes (9 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about the American Dream?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about class and money?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about the past and time?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about illusion and reality?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about carelessness and morality?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the novel in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the chapter quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Chapter I Chapter II Chapter III Chapter IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the American Dream* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Chapter V *Socratic seminar on the American Dream* Chapter VI Chapter VII Chapter VIII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*class and money* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the American Dream • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Chapter IX *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	4 × 90 min (360 min)	*the past and time* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Great Gatsby

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about F. Scott Fitzgerald's life or times connects to the American Dream in “The Great Gatsby”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (the American Dream, class and money, the past and time).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Francis Scott Key Fitzgerald was born in St. Paul, Minnesota, on 24 September 1896, named for a distant relative who wrote "The Star-Spangled Banner." He attended Princeton University but left without a degree and joined the U.S. Army in 1917; the war ended before he was sent overseas. While stationed near Montgomery, Alabama, he met Zelda Sayre, who married him in 1920, a week after his first novel, This Side of Paradise, made him famous. The Fitzgeralds became celebrities of what he named "the Jazz Age," living in New York, on Long Island (Great Neck, 1922–24) and in France, where he wrote most of The Great Gatsby. His later years were marked by debt, alcoholism and Zelda's psychiatric illness; he published Tender Is the Night (1934), wrote for Hollywood, and died of a heart attack in Hollywood on 21 December 1940, aged 44, leaving The Last Tycoon unfinished. He believed himself a failure; Gatsby's reputation grew only after his death.

Historical and cultural context

The novel is set in the summer of 1922 on Long Island and in New York City. Fitzgerald wrote most of it in France in 1924, after living in Great Neck, Long Island, which became his West Egg. The 1920s brought Prohibition (the Eighteenth Amendment, in force from 1920), which made bootlegging and organized crime enormously profitable; a booming stock market and new fortunes; mass-produced cars; jazz; and new freedoms for young women (the "flapper"). Meyer Wolfshiem's fixing of the 1919 World Series alludes to the real Black Sox scandal, usually linked to the gambler Arnold Rothstein. Tom Buchanan's talk of a book about "the Coloured Empires" echoes real racist best-sellers of the period, such as Lothrop Stoddard's The Rising Tide of Color (1920).

Publication and reception, then and now

Charles Scribner's Sons published The Great Gatsby on 10 April 1925, edited by Maxwell Perkins, with Francis Cugat's painting of a woman's face above a carnival-lit city on the jacket. Fitzgerald had considered other titles, including "Trimalchio in West Egg." The book entered the United States public domain on 1 January 2021.

Then: Sales disappointed Fitzgerald: the book sold far fewer copies than his first two novels, and some reviews were dismissive. Writers admired it; T. S. Eliot wrote to Fitzgerald that it seemed "the first step that American fiction has taken since Henry James." When Fitzgerald died in 1940 he thought himself forgotten.

Now: Interest revived after his death; during the Second World War the book was printed in the Armed Services Editions sent to American troops. It is now one of the most taught American novels and a standard candidate for "the Great American Novel." Film versions include those of 1949, 1974 (with Robert Redford)

and 2013 (Baz Luhrmann). Modern readers debate Nick's reliability, the novel's treatment of class and race, and what it says about the American Dream.

Overview (spoiler-free)

In the summer of 1922 Nick Carraway, a young Midwesterner, rents a small house on Long Island next to the mansion of the mysterious Jay Gatsby, who throws enormous parties. Across the bay live Nick's cousin Daisy and her rich husband Tom. Nick tells us what he learned that summer about Gatsby and the people around him.

Main themes

- the American Dream: Gatsby remakes himself from nothing; ask whether the dream is noble, corrupt or impossible.
- class and money: old money, new money and the people who pay for both.
- the past and time: "Can't repeat the past? Why of course you can!"
- illusion and reality: Gatsby's invented self, Daisy as a dream, Nick's own self-image as honest.
- carelessness and morality: who cleans up after the careless rich?

Why it matters

The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.

Spoilers · teacher only

Gatsby, born James Gatz, loved Daisy before the war and has made a fortune, partly through bootlegging, to win her back. Nick arranges their reunion; the affair revives. In a hot confrontation at the Plaza Hotel, Tom exposes Gatsby's criminal dealings and Daisy cannot say she never loved Tom. Driving Gatsby's car home, Daisy hits and kills Tom's mistress, Myrtle Wilson; Gatsby takes the blame. Tom tells Myrtle's grieving husband George that the car was Gatsby's; Wilson shoots Gatsby and then himself. Tom and Daisy leave town; almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral. Nick returns to the Midwest.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Before we open The Great Gatsby: What does "the American Dream" mean to you? Is it still possible? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open The Great Gatsby: What does "the American Dream" mean to you? Is it still possible? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

Key literary terms for the unit.

narrator (the person telling the story; here a character, Nick); unreliable narrator (one whose account we may not fully trust); symbol (an object that stands for an idea); Prohibition (the 1920–1933 national ban on making and selling alcohol); bootlegger (someone who sold alcohol illegally); old money and new money (inherited wealth versus newly made fortunes); the Jazz Age (Fitzgerald's name for the 1920s).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Francis Scott Key Fitzgerald was born in St. Paul, Minnesota, on 24 September 1896, named for a distant relative who wrote "The Star-Spangled Banner." He attended Princeton University but left without a degree and joined the U.S. Army in 1917; the war ended before he was sent overseas. While stationed near Montgomery, Alabama, he met Zelda Sayre, who married him in 1920, a week after his first novel, This Side of Paradise, made him famous. The Fitzgeralds became celebrities of what he named "the Jazz Age," living in New York, on Long Island (Great Neck, 1922–24) and in France, where he wrote most of The Great Gatsby. His later years were marked by debt, alcoholism and Zelda's psychiatric illness; he published Tender Is the Night (1934), wrote for Hollywood, and died of a heart attack in Hollywood on 21 December 1940, aged 44, leaving The Last Tycoon unfinished. He believed himself a failure; Gatsby's reputation grew only after his death. The world of the book. The novel is set in the summer of 1922 on Long Island and in New York City. Fitzgerald wrote most of it in France in 1924, after living in Great Neck, Long Island, which became his West Egg. The 1920s brought Prohibition (the Eighteenth Amendment, in force from 1920), which made bootlegging and organized crime enormously profitable; a booming stock market and new fortunes; mass-produced cars; jazz; and new freedoms for young women (the "flapper"). Meyer Wolfshiem's fixing of the 1919 World Series alludes to the real Black Sox scandal, usually linked to the gambler Arnold Rothstein. Tom Buchanan's talk of a book about "the Coloured Empires" echoes real racist best-sellers of the period, such as Lothrop Stoddard's The Rising Tide of Color (1920). Publication and reception. Charles Scribner's Sons published The Great Gatsby on 10 April 1925, edited by Maxwell Perkins, with Francis Cugat's painting of a woman's face above a carnival-lit city on the jacket. Fitzgerald had considered other titles, including "Trimalchio in West Egg." The book entered the United States public domain on 1 January 2021. Then: Sales disappointed Fitzgerald: the book sold far fewer copies than his first two novels, and some reviews were dismissive. Writers admired it; T. S. Eliot wrote to Fitzgerald that it seemed "the first step that American fiction has taken since Henry James." When Fitzgerald died in 1940 he thought himself forgotten. Now: Interest revived after his death; during the Second World War the book was printed in the Armed Services Editions sent to American troops. It is now one of the most taught American novels and a standard candidate for "the Great American Novel." Film versions include those of 1949, 1974 (with Robert Redford) and 2013 (Baz Luhrmann). Modern readers debate Nick's reliability, the novel's treatment of class and race, and what it says about the American Dream.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick says we keep rowing forward like boats against the current, but we are carried back again and again into the past. Next, craft. I notice the image of boats rowing against a current, and the "b" sounds (beat, boats, borne, back) that make the sentence pull like a tide. The strongest word is "ceaselessly": it means without stopping, so the struggle against the past never ends. Then, effect. What does the novel's last sentence say about Gatsby's dream and about us? My answer: Gatsby's effort to recover 1917 and Daisy is everyone's effort; Fitzgerald ends by saying that striving toward the future keeps dragging us back to what we have lost.

> *So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past (Chapter IX, paragraph 162)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick says we keep rowing forward like boats against the current, but we are carried back again and again into the past. Next, craft. I notice the image of boats rowing against a current, and the "b" sounds (beat, boats, borne, back) that make the sentence pull like a tide. The strongest word is "ceaselessly": it means without stopping, so the struggle against the past never ends. Then, effect. What does the novel's last sentence say about Gatsby's dream and about us? My answer: Gatsby's effort to recover 1917 and Daisy is everyone's effort; Fitzgerald ends by saying that striving toward the future keeps dragging us back to what we have lost.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): In the summer of 1922 Nick Carraway, a young Midwesterner, rents a small house on Long Island next to the mansion of the mysterious Jay Gatsby, who throws enormous parties. Across the bay live Nick's cousin Daisy and her rich husband Tom. Nick tells us what he learned that summer about Gatsby and the people around him. Themes to track: the American Dream: Gatsby remakes himself from nothing; ask whether the dream is noble, corrupt or impossible. class and money: old money, new money and the people who pay for both. the past and time: "Can't repeat the past? Why of course you can!" illusion and reality: Gatsby's invented self, Daisy as a dream, Nick's own self-image as honest. carelessness and morality: who cleans up after the careless rich?

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "illusion and reality": Prediction: Gatsby is not who he says he is. Question: does Nick tell us everything, or only what he wants us to see?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Great Gatsby: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "illusion and reality": Prediction: Gatsby is not who he says he is. Question: does Nick tell us everything, or only what he wants us to see?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.

Why does The Great Gatsby still matter? The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.

Anchor question: Why might The Great Gatsby still be taught today?

Facilitation: The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).

Fitzgerald wrote the novel in 1924 during the boom years after World War I, and he and Zelda lived the glamorous, hard-drinking life of the Jazz Age. How might that experience shape a novel about wealthy parties? Answer: Accept answers such as: he knew the excitement and emptiness of rich parties; he felt like an outsider among old money; Prohibition-era bootlegging was all around him.

Exit ticket: Fitzgerald wrote the novel in 1924 during the boom years after World War I, and he and Zelda lived the glamorous, hard-drinking life of the Jazz Age. How might that experience shape a novel about wealthy parties?

Answer: Accept answers such as: he knew the excitement and emptiness of rich parties; he felt like an outsider among old money; Prohibition-era bootlegging was all around him.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Preview the first reading.

Tomorrow we begin reading: Chapter I.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "F. Scott Fitzgerald" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/F-Scott-Fitzgerald); University of South Carolina Libraries, F. Scott Fitzgerald Collection, "Fitzgerald biography" (https://sc.edu/about/offices_and_divisions/university_libraries/browse/irvin_dept_special_collections/fitzgerald/); Britannica, "The Great Gatsby" (https://www.britannica.com/topic/The-Great-Gatsby); Library of Congress, "Prohibition: A Case Study of Progressive Reform" (https://www.loc.gov/classroom-materials/united-states-history-primary-source-timeline/progressive-era-to-new-era-1900-1929/prohibition-case-study-of-progressive-reform/); Princeton University Library, F. Scott Fitzgerald Papers (https://findingaids.princeton.edu/catalog/C0187); Duke University Center for the Study of the Public Domain, "Public Domain Day 2021" (https://web.law.duke.edu/cspd/publicdomainday/2021/); T. S. Eliot, letter to Fitzgerald, 31 December 1925 (printed in Fitzgerald, The Crack-Up, 1945) (https://www.worldcat.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Sales figures for 1925 vary by source (a first printing of about 20,000 and a smaller second printing are usually cited); avoid exact numbers unless you check them.
- The Rothstein link to Wolfshiem is a common identification, not something Fitzgerald stated in the novel.

- The Armed Services Editions printing (1945) is well documented; the often-quoted figure of about 150,000 copies should be checked before use.

Critical voice: “Scott Fitzgerald’s new novel, “The Great Gatsby” is in form no more than a glorified anecdote, and not too probable at that.” (H. L. Mencken, critic and journalist, *Review of The Great Gatsby, Chicago Sunday Tribune (3 May 1925), reprinted as "Time Machine" (10 Oct 2014), paragraph 1*; public domain). Then/now: the most powerful critic of 1925 called it an anecdote. Students list what a 1925 reader could not yet see. *Objective:* Compare the novel's 1925 reception with its standing today. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9, SL.11-12.1

Critical voice: “has mastered his talents and gone soaring in a beautiful flight, leaving behind him everything dubious and tricky in his earlier work, and leaving even farther behind all the men of his own generation and most of his elders.” (Gilbert Seldes, critic, *"Spring Flight," The Dial 79 (August 1925), as quoted in "1925: Seventy-five Years Ago," American Heritage 51:2 (April 2000), American Heritage, paragraph 4*; public domain). Contrast Seldes with Mencken: same year, opposite verdicts. (Checked only against a secondary source; check The Dial page scan before print.) *Objective:* Introduce Fitzgerald's style as the novel's distinguishing achievement. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

Lesson 2: Chapter I

Focus: Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “Chapter I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (racist ideas (a character), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Tom praises a racist book about 'the Coloured Empires' and the dominance of 'the Nordic race.' Fitzgerald makes Tom look foolish, but elsewhere the narration itself reproduces racial and antisemitic stereotypes (Ch II, IV, VII, IX); students should be able to discuss both. Name the real 1920s pseudo-science Tom echoes. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…ng-cake of the ceiling, and then rippled over the wine-coloured rug, making a shadow on it as…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: A character repeats racist ideas from a 1920s book.
Suggested language: “What does Tom's speech show about him, and how do the others react?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football star with a 'cruel body') and the golfer Jordan Baker. Tom rants about a racist book; a phone call reveals that Tom has a mistress; Daisy tells Nick she hopes her daughter will be 'a beautiful little fool.' Back home, Nick sees Gatsby alone on his lawn, stretching his arms toward a green light across the water.

Background: Great Neck and Manhasset Neck on Long Island's North Shore were home to new show-business fortunes and old society families in the early 1920s; Fitzgerald lived in Great Neck in 1922–24. After the First World War many young men from the Midwest moved east to work in finance, as Nick does.

Significance: The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: A character repeats racist ideas from a 1920s book.
Prompt: Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pathfinder — someone who finds or shows the way in new country; wedging — forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place; anticlimax — a disappointing letdown after something exciting; supercilious — behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud; egotism — an inflated sense of one's own importance. "supercilious": Origin: Latin superciliōsus ("haughty"). "egotism": Origin: possibly Latin ego ("I").
Words: pathfinder: someone who finds or shows the way in new country · wedging: forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place · anticlimax: a disappointing letdown after something exciting · supercilious: behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud · egotism: an inflated sense of one's own importance

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Great Neck and Manhasset Neck on Long Island's North Shore were home to new show-business fortunes and old society families in the early 1920s; Fitzgerald lived in Great Neck in 1922–24. After the First World War many young men from the Midwest moved east to work in finance, as Nick does. The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light. Point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Setting: West Egg (new money, Nick's "eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay. Characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Watch for the green light: Gatsby, alone at night, stretches his arms toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick recalls advice from his father that he has kept turning over in his mind since he was young. Next, craft. I notice he presents himself as thoughtful and impressionable, "younger and more vulnerable," before telling us anything else. The strongest word is "vulnerable": it shows he wants to seem open and easily hurt, which makes us trust him. Then, effect. What does Nick want us to think about him from his father's advice? My answer: From his father's advice, Nick wants us to think of him as a fair, reserved judge who is slow to criticize others; the novel will test whether that self-image is true.

> *In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since (Chapter I, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick recalls advice from his father that he has kept turning over in his mind since he was young. Next, craft. I notice he presents himself as thoughtful and impressionable, "younger and more vulnerable," before telling us anything else. The strongest word is "vulnerable": it shows he wants to seem open and easily hurt, which makes us trust him. Then, effect. What does Nick want us to think about him from his father's advice? My answer: From his father's advice, Nick wants us to think of him as a fair, reserved judge who is slow to criticize others; the novel will test whether that self-image is true.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Daisy says a girl is best off a "beautiful little fool" because a smart woman sees how little power she has. Expected link: class and money; gender in the 1920s. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. (Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.)

> *I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool (Chapter I, paragraph 118)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Daisy says a girl is best off a "beautiful little fool" because a smart woman sees how little power she has. Expected link: class and money; gender in the 1920s.
Ask: How does this line connect to class and money?
Expected answer: The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. (Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for point of view, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. When the text says “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152), it shows this directly. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. When the text says “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152), it shows this directly. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not? Ask: what kind of person is Nick? List what he says about himself and what he shows.

Anchor question: Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?

Facilitation: Ask: what kind of person is Nick? List what he says about himself and what he shows.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. ("a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock", Chapter I, paragraph 152). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. ("a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock", Chapter I, paragraph 152). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Key takeaway: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.
- **Setting:** West Egg (new money, Nick's "eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay.
- **Characterization:** Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom.

Themes and how they develop

- **class and money:** the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** Gatsby, alone at night, stretches his arms toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1) The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

- "I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool" (Chapter I, paragraph 118) Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.
- "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152) First image of the green light.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested.
Evidence: "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152)
Reasoning: He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pathfinder (noun)	someone who finds or shows the way in new country	*I was a guide, a pathfinder, an original settler.*	
wedging (verb)	forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place	*Before I could reply that he was my neighbour dinner was announced; wedging his tense arm imperatively under mine, Tom Buchanan compelled me from the room as though he were moving a checker to another square.*	
anticlimax (noun)	a disappointing letdown after something exciting	*Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who reach such an acute limited excellence at twenty-one that everything afterward savours of anticlimax.*	
supercilious (adjective)	behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud	*Now he was a sturdy straw-haired man of thirty, with a rather hard mouth and a supercilious manner.*	"supercilious": Origin: Latin superciliōsus ("haughty"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/supercilious#Etymology)
egotism (noun)	an inflated sense of one's own importance	*Something was making him nibble at the edge of stale ideas as if his sturdy physical egotism no longer nourished his peremptory heart.*	"egotism": Origin: possibly Latin ego ("I"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/egotism#Etymology)

contributory (adjective)	given as a share or contribution (here, an emotion Nick is tricked into supplying)	*It made me uneasy, as though the whole evening had been a trick of some sort to exact a contributory emotion from me.*	
aggressively (adverb)	in a forceful, threatening way	*Two shining arrogant eyes had established dominance over his face and gave him the appearance of always leaning aggressively forward.*	
alertly (adverb)	in a watchful, wide-awake way	*I was about to speak when she sat up alertly and said "Sh!" in a warning voice.*	
unobtrusively (adverb)	quietly, without drawing attention	*Sometimes she and Miss Baker talked at once, unobtrusively and with a bantering inconsequence that was never quite chatter, that was as cool as their white dresses and their impersonal eyes in the absence of all desire.*	
irrecoverable (adjective)	lost for good; impossible to get back	*This was a permanent move, said Daisy over the telephone, but I didn't believe it—I had no sight into Daisy's heart, but I felt that Tom would drift on forever seeking, a little wistfully, for the dramatic turbulence of some irrecoverable football game.*	

Discussion questions

1. Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the American Dream?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What sport did Tom play at Yale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Football; he was a famous end.

2. What does Jordan Baker do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is a golf champion.
3. Where does Nick rent a house? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: West Egg
4. What business has Nick come East to learn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bonds
5. How is Nick related to Daisy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Second cousin once removed
6. What does Daisy hope her daughter will be? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A beautiful little fool
7. What does Gatsby reach toward at the end of the chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A green light
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football star with a 'cruel body') and the golfer Jordan Baker. Tom rants about a racist book; a phone call…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter I"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the narrator begin with his father's advice? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: To present himself as fair and reserved, which the reader can then test.
2. What do the descriptions of East and West Egg suggest about class? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: East Egg is older, more fashionable money; West Egg is new and showy.
3. What does "Chapter I" suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.
4. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
5. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. On setting: West Egg (new money, Nick's

"eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who…”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football…
8. As the opening chapter, what does “Chapter I” set up that the rest of The Great Gatsby will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. On characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Nick reliable after Chapter I? Defend your answer with two details. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment based on his claims and his sharp judgments of others.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. What does Daisy's 'beautiful little fool' line say about women's choices in 1922? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned connection to gender and power.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. On characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter I” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. On point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to class and money: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. On point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Compare how “Chapter I” treats Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Something was making him nibble at the edge of stale ideas as if his sturdy physical _____ no longer nourished his peremptory heart." Word bank: pathfinder, egotism, anticlimax, wedging
   Key: egotism
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Before I could reply that he was my neighbour dinner was announced; wedging his tense arm imperatively under mine, Tom Buchanan compelled me from the room as though he were moving a checker to another square.", what does "wedging" most nearly mean?
   A. people paid to drive a private car
   B. designs made of a person's initials
   C. forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place
   D. without care for others' feelings; awkwardly

   Key: C (forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 1: "In my younger and more _____ years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since"
   Key: vulnerable
4. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What sport did Tom play at Yale?
   Sample answer: Football; he was a famous end.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby reach toward at the end of the chapter?
   A. His mansion
   B. The moon
   C. A boat
   D. A green light

   Key: D (A green light)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who reach such an acute limited excellence…", what does "anticlimax" most nearly mean?
   A. a disappointing letdown after something exciting
   B. juicy and tasty
   C. loose short trousers gathered just below the knee
   D. strongly suggestive of; smelling of

   Key: A (a disappointing letdown after something exciting)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Now he was a sturdy straw-haired man of thirty, with a rather hard mouth and a supercilious manner.", what does "supercilious" most nearly mean?
   A. behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud
   B. to confirm that something is true
   C. in a showy, too-bright way
   D. hard to catch hold of or remember

Key: A (behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Two shining arrogant eyes had established dominance over his face and gave him the appearance of always leaning _____ forward." Word bank: pathfinder, wedging, aggressively, anticlimax

   Key: aggressively

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jordan Baker do?

   Sample answer: She is a golf champion.

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What business has Nick come East to learn?

    A. Medicine

    B. Bonds

    C. Journalism

    D. Law

    Key: B (Bonds)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter I"?

    A. The reunion

    B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

    C. The Plaza and the death car

    D. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

    Key: D (Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the narrator begin with his father's advice?

    Sample answer: To present himself as fair and reserved, which the reader can then test. The evidence is "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1), which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What do the descriptions of East and West Egg suggest about class?

    Sample answer: East Egg is older, more fashionable money; West Egg is new and showy. The evidence is "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1), which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

    A. Class and money

    B. The past and time

    C. The American Dream

    D. Illusion and reality

    Key: A (Class and money)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter I"? West Egg (new money, Nick's 'eyesore' and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay.

    A. Conflict

    B. Setting

    C. Irony

D. Metaphor

Key: B (Setting)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Nick reliable after Chapter I? Defend your answer with two details.

    Sample answer: A judgment based on his claims and his sharp judgments of others. The evidence is “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118) — Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Daisy hope her daughter will be?

    A. A doctor

    B. Rich

    C. Famous

    D. A beautiful little fool

    Key: D (A beautiful little fool)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is Nick related to Daisy?

    A. Husband

    B. Neighbour only

    C. Brother

    D. Second cousin once removed

    Key: D (Second cousin once removed)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 118: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a _____ little fool”

    Key: beautiful

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It made me uneasy, as though the whole evening had been a trick of some sort to exact a _____ emotion from me.”

    Word bank: contributory, wedging, pathfinder, anticlimax

    Key: contributory

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter I”? Nick introduces himself as a narrator ‘inclined to reserve all judgements,’ then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.

    A. Point of view

    B. Symbolism

    C. Plot

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Point of view)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how class and money develops from the opening of “Chapter I” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1), which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as

thoughtful and fair. Later, “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152) — First image of the green light. The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 152: “a _____ green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock”
    Key: single

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was about to speak when she sat up _____ and said ‘Sh!’ in a warning voice.” Word bank: pathfinder, anticlimax, wedging, alertly
    Key: alertly

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. The evidence is “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1).

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Daisy's 'beautiful little fool' line say about women's choices in 1922?
    Sample answer: A reasoned connection to gender and power. The evidence is “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118) — Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152).
    Sample answer: He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.". The evidence is “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152) — First image of the green light. This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Nick rent a house?

    A. Chicago
    B. West Egg
    C. East Egg
    D. Manhattan

    Key: B (West Egg)

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118)

    A. The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.
    B. The reason for everything.

C. Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.

D. Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

Key: C (Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1)

    A. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

    B. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

    C. The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

    D. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

    Key: B (The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.)

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 13: “It was a matter of chance that I should have rented a house in one of the strangest _____ in North America.”

    Word bank: millionaires, communities, happened, irrelevant

    Key: communities

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 13 shapes its tone: “Twenty miles from the city a pair of enormous eggs, identical in contour and separated only by a courtesy bay, jut out into the most domesticated body of salt water in the Western hemisphere, the great wet barnyard of Long Island Sound.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “domesticated” and “hemisphere” (Chapter I, paragraph 13) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: “Everybody I knew was in the bond business, so I supposed it could support one more single man.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “business” and “supposed” (Chapter I, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 128 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “I knew now why her face was familiar—its pleasing contemptuous expression had looked out at me from many rotogravure pictures of the sporting life at Asheville and Hot Springs and Palm Beach.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter I, paragraph 128) develops the past and time: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Its words “contemptuous” and “rotogravure” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I can’t seem to remember, but I think we talked about the Nordic race.” (Chapter I, paragraph 142), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. The evidence is “In my younger and

more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words "vulnerable" and "younger" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 29 to the story's treatment of the past and time: "The other girl, Daisy, made an attempt to rise—she leaned slightly forward with a conscientious expression—then she laughed, an absurd, charming little laugh, and I laughed too and came forward into the room." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter I, paragraph 29) develops the past and time: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Its words "conscientious" and "expression" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Almost any exhibition of complete self-sufficiency draws a stunned tribute from me." (Chapter I, paragraph 32), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? "I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool" (Chapter I, paragraph 118) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. The evidence is "I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool" (Chapter I, paragraph 118).

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? "In consequence, I'm inclined to reserve all judgements, a habit that has opened up many curious natures to me and also made me the victim of not a few veteran bores." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter I, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words "consequence" and "judgements" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: "The front was broken by a line of French windows, glowing now with reflected gold and wide open to the warm windy afternoon, and Tom Buchanan in riding clothes was standing with his legs apart on the front porch." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter I, paragraph 18) develops carelessness and morality: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Its words "reflected" and "afternoon" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "We walked through a high hallway into a bright rosy-coloured space, fragilely bound into the house by French windows at…" (Chapter I, paragraph 26), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter I, paragraph 109 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: "In its deep gloom we sat down side by side on a wicker settee." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter I, paragraph 109) develops carelessness and morality: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Its words "settee" and "wicker" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "I waited but she didn't say any more, and after a moment I returned rather feebly to the subject of her

daughter." (Chapter I, paragraph 114), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: First image of the green light. The evidence is "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152). This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words "minute" and "single" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 17, 18, 2, 19, 1, 8, 7, 20, 12, 11, 13, 15, 14, 21, 22	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 7, 20, 23, 10, 24, 17, 12, 25, 13, 11, 14, 15, 21, 16, 26	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 3, 17, 5, 9, 6, 13, 12, 25, 11, 15, 27, 14, 21, 22, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 10, 7, 23, 20, 25, 11, 13, 12, 27, 14, 21, 15, 16, 26, 22	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 1, 17, 9, 11, 13, 29, 12, 30, 15, 21, 14, 27, 22, 16, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Freshman	8, 1, 5, 10, 4, 12, 30, 13, 11, 15, 14, 27, 21, 26, 22, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	8, 31, 28, 10, 12, 13, 32, 33, 15, 27, 21, 34, 35, 26, 36, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 20, 18, 2, 37, 11, 12, 13, 25, 14, 27, 15, 21, 22, 26, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Senior	1, 20, 30, 38, 21, 32, 33, 15, 14, 36, 26, 34, 39, 16, 40, 22	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	1, 20, 28, 30, 14, 41, 32, 15, 33, 16, 40, 22, 36, 26, 34, 39	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter I," how does Fitzgerald show Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In Chapter I, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses point of view in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who reach such an acute limited excellence at twenty-one that everything afterward savours of anticlimax.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "anticlimax" most nearly mean?

   A. lost for good; impossible to get back

   B. in a watchful, wide-awake way

   C. quietly, without drawing attention

   D. a disappointing letdown after something exciting

2. *Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who reach such an acute limited excellence at twenty-one that everything afterward savours of anticlimax. His family were enormously wealthy—even in college his freedom with money was a matter for reproach—but now he'd left Chicago and come East in a fashion that rather took your breath away: for instance, he'd brought down a string of polo ponies from Lake Forest. It was hard to realize that a man in my own generation was wealthy enough to do that.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter I"?

   A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

   B. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

   C. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   D. The Plaza and the death car

SAT key: 1. D (a disappointing letdown after something exciting); 2. C (Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans)

Lesson 3: Chapter II

Focus: the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Chapter II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "Social leader and jailbird, grand lady and kept woman, are here almost indistinguishable." (H. L. Mencken, critic and journalist, *Review of The Great Gatsby, Chicago Sunday Tribune (3 May 1925), reprinted as "Time Machine" (10 Oct 2014), final paragraph*; public domain). Character sort: who at the apartment party is pretending to a class they do not belong to? *Objective:* Analyze class mixing at Myrtle's party. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (domestic violence, heavy drinking, adultery, antisemitic slur): Tom breaks Myrtle's nose; the chapter centres on his affair and a drunken party; Mrs. McKee uses an antisemitic slur. Do not read the slur aloud and do not let students say it; name it as a slur and discuss what it shows about the speaker and the period.
Student preview: This chapter includes an affair, heavy drinking, a man hitting a woman, and an antisemitic slur spoken by a character.
Suggested language: "What does this party reveal about the people at it?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine and the McKees, Myrtle buys a dog and puts on airs. When she shouts Daisy's name, Tom breaks her nose with his open hand.

Background: The ash dump was modeled on the Corona ash dumps in Queens, where coal ash and garbage were dumped; it was later transformed into Flushing Meadows for the 1939 World's Fair. Billboards along new roads were a sign of the car age.

Significance: The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does a place reveal about the people who live there? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: This chapter includes an affair, heavy drinking, a man hitting a woman, and an antisemitic slur spoken by a character.
Prompt: What does a place reveal about the people who live there?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: chiffon — a thin, sheer, light fabric; oculist — an eye doctor; flounced — moved with quick, showy, impatient movements; strident — loud, harsh and insistent; hauteur — haughty, proud manner. "chiffon": Origin: French chiffon; earlier Middle French chiffe ("cloth"). "oculist": Origin: French oculiste; earlier Latin oculus ("eye").
Words: chiffon: a thin, sheer, light fabric · oculist: an eye doctor · flounced: moved with quick, showy, impatient movements · strident: loud, harsh and insistent · hauteur: haughty, proud manner

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ash dump was modeled on the Corona ash dumps in Queens, where coal ash and garbage were dumped; it was later transformed into Flushing Meadows for the 1939 World's Fair. Billboards along new roads were a sign of the car age. The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class. Setting: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Symbolism: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "saw us a damp gleam of hope sprang into his light blue eyes" (Chapter II, paragraph 8).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "This is a valley of ashes" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick describes the gray wasteland between West Egg and New York. Next, craft. I notice the short, flat sentence, like a signpost, and a phrase that sounds like a biblical valley of death. The strongest word is "ashes": ashes are what remains after burning, so the place is the waste left by the rich. Then, effect. Why does Fitzgerald call this place "a valley of ashes"? My answer: Fitzgerald calls this place "a valley of ashes" because it is where the waste of the wealthy Eggs is dumped: the poor who live in its dust, like the Wilsons, are used up so others can be rich.

> *This is a valley of ashes (Chapter II, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "This is a valley of ashes" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick describes the gray wasteland between West Egg and New York. Next, craft. I notice the short, flat sentence, like a signpost, and a phrase that sounds like a biblical valley of death. The strongest word is "ashes": ashes are what remains after burning, so the place is the waste left by the rich. Then, effect. Why does Fitzgerald call this place "a valley of ashes"? My answer: Fitzgerald calls this place "a valley of ashes" because it is where the waste of the wealthy Eggs is dumped: the poor who live in its dust, like the Wilsons, are used up so others can be rich.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The billboard eyes. Look at the craft: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. (The billboard eyes.)

> *The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic* (Chapter II, paragraph 2)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The billboard eyes. Look at the craft: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing.
Ask: How does this line connect to class and money?
Expected answer: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. (The billboard eyes.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. When the text says “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. When the text says “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does a place reveal about the people who live there? Ask: why does Fitzgerald put the valley of ashes between the Eggs and the city?
Anchor question: What does a place reveal about the people who live there?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Fitzgerald put the valley of ashes between the Eggs and the city?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. ("This is a valley of ashes", Chapter II, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. ("This is a valley of ashes", Chapter II, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Key takeaway: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.
- **Symbolism:** Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing.
- **Characterization:** Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand.

Themes and how they develop

- **class and money:** Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "saw us a damp gleam of hope sprang into his light blue eyes" (Chapter II, paragraph 8).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "drift endlessly over it, you perceive, after a moment, the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. The eyes of Doctor T. J" (Chapter II, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1) The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.
- "The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic" (Chapter II, paragraph 2) The billboard eyes.
- "Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand" (Chapter II, paragraph 127) Tom's casual violence.
- "I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life" (Chapter II, paragraph 119) Nick's double position.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs.
Evidence: "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chiffon (noun)	a thin, sheer, light fabric	*Wilson had changed her costume some time before, and was now attired in an elaborate afternoon dress of cream-coloured chiffon, which gave out a continual rustle as she swept about the room.*	"chiffon": Origin: French chiffon; earlier Middle French chiffe ("cloth"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/chiffon#Etymology)
oculist (noun)	an eye doctor	*Evidently some wild wag of an oculist set them there to fatten his practice in the borough of Queens, and then sank down himself into eternal blindness, or forgot them and moved away.*	"oculist": Origin: French oculiste; earlier Latin oculus ("eye"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oculist#Etymology)
flounced (verb)	moved with quick, showy, impatient movements	*Then she flounced over to the dog, kissed it with ecstasy, and swept into the kitchen, implying that a dozen chefs awaited her orders there.*	
strident (adjective)	loud, harsh and insistent	*I wanted to get out and walk eastward toward the park through the soft twilight, but each time I tried to go I became entangled in some wild, strident argument which pulled me back, as if with ropes, into my chair.*	
hauteur (noun)	haughty, proud manner	*The intense vitality that had been so remarkable in the garage was converted into impressive hauteur.*	

contiguous (adjective)	touching or next to (here: next to nothing at all)	*The only building in sight was a small block of yellow brick sitting on the edge of the waste land, a sort of compact Main Street ministering to it, and contiguous to absolutely nothing.*	
sumptuous (adjective)	splendid and costly-looking	*It had occurred to me that this shadow of a garage must be a blind, and that sumptuous and romantic apartments were concealed overhead, when the proprietor himself appeared in the door of an office, wiping his hands on a piece of waste.*	
anaemic (adjective)	pale and lacking energy (British spelling of anemic)	*He was a blond, spiritless man, anaemic, and faintly handsome.*	
ambiguously (adverb)	in a way that can be understood more than one way	*"Well, I married him," said Myrtle, ambiguously.*	
proprietary (adjective)	acting like an owner; possessive	*She came in with such a proprietary haste, and looked around so possessively at the furniture that I wondered if she lived here.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does a place reveal about the people who live there?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with class and money?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is Catherine? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Myrtle's sister.
2. What rumour does Catherine repeat about Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he is a nephew or cousin of Kaiser Wilhelm.
3. What lies between West Egg and New York? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A valley of ashes

4. Whose eyes look out from the billboard? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's
5. What does George Wilson do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Runs a garage
6. What does Myrtle buy on the way to the apartment? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A dog
7. What does Tom do when Myrtle says Daisy's name? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Breaks her nose
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine and the McKees, Myrtle buys a dog and puts on airs. When she shouts Daisy's name, Tom breaks her nose…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter II"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why are Eckleburg's eyes described as watching the valley? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: They suggest a god-like witness, or the absence of one.
2. Why does Myrtle act grand at the apartment? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She performs the class she hopes Tom will give her.
3. What does "Chapter II" suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.
4. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. On symbolism: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "But above the grey land and the spasms of bleak dust which drift endlessly over it, you perceive, after a moment, the eyes of Doctor T.", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular

words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine…
8. How does “Chapter II” build on “Chapter I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What does a place reveal about the people who live there?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Myrtle a victim, a social climber, or both? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Why does Nick stay at the party although he wants to leave? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: His fascination and passivity: 'within and without'.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.” How far do you agree? Take a

stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the past and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On setting: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter II” treats the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Wilson had changed her costume some time before, and was now attired in an elaborate afternoon dress of cream-coloured chiffon, which gave out a continual rustle as she swept about the room.”, what does “chiffon” most nearly mean?

   A. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

   B. the quality of giving off light; brightness

   C. a thin, sheer, light fabric

   D. given as a share or contribution (here, an emotion Nick is tricked into supplying)

   Key: C (a thin, sheer, light fabric)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I wanted to get out and walk eastward toward the park through the soft twilight, but each time I tried to go I became entangled in some wild, strident argument which pulled me back, as if with ropes, into my chair.”, what does “strident” most nearly mean?

   A. loud, harsh and insistent

   B. quietly, without drawing attention

   C. built up in rising layers or rows

   D. people paid to drive a private car

   Key: A (loud, harsh and insistent)

3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What rumour does Catherine repeat about Gatsby?

   Sample answer: That he is a nephew or cousin of Kaiser Wilhelm.

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 127: “Making a short deft _____, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand”

   Key: movement

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What lies between West Egg and New York?

   A. A lake

   B. A golf course

   C. A forest

   D. A valley of ashes

   Key: D (A valley of ashes)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 119: “I was within and without, _____ enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life”

   Key: simultaneously

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is Catherine?

   Sample answer: Myrtle's sister.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Then she flounced over to the dog, kissed it with ecstasy, and swept into the kitchen, implying that a dozen chefs awaited her orders there.”, what does “flounced” most nearly mean?

   A. a strange, mixed collection (literally, of wild animals)

   B. moved with quick, showy, impatient movements

   C. dull, without shine

   D. to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering

   Key: B (moved with quick, showy, impatient movements)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It had occurred to me that this shadow of a garage must be a blind, and that _____ and romantic apartments were concealed overhead, when the proprietor himself appeared in the door of an office, wiping his hands on a piece of waste.” Word bank: chiffon, sumptuous, flounced, oculist

   Key: sumptuous

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?

    A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

    B. The reunion

    C. James Gatz and the second party

D. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

Key: D (The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why are Eckleburg's eyes described as watching the valley?
Sample answer: They suggest a god-like witness, or the absence of one. The evidence is "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1), which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Myrtle act grand at the apartment?
Sample answer: She performs the class she hopes Tom will give her. The evidence is "Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand" (Chapter II, paragraph 127) — Tom's casual violence.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter II"? Eckleburg's eyes 'brood on over the solemn dumping ground': a god-like witness who sees nothing.
A. Personification
B. Diction / vocabulary
C. Metaphor
D. Symbolism

Key: D (Symbolism)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand" (Chapter II, paragraph 127). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Tom's casual violence. The evidence is "Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand" (Chapter II, paragraph 127). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words "movement" and "short" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how class and money develops from Chapter I to Chapter II. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter I, paragraph 1, the text reads "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since", which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. In Chapter II, "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1), which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The intense vitality that had been so remarkable in the garage was converted into impressive _____." Word bank: oculist, flounced, hauteur, chiffon
Key: hauteur

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does George Wilson do?
A. Plays golf
B. Runs a garage
C. Sells bonds
D. Bootlegs

Key: B (Runs a garage)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 1: “This is a _____ of ashes”

    Key: valley

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Evidently some wild wag of an oculist set them there to fatten his practice in the borough of Queens, and then sank down himself into eternal blindness, or forgot them and moved away.”, what does “oculist” most nearly mean?

    A. in a showy, too-bright way

    B. an eye doctor

    C. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

    D. designs made of a person's initials

    Key: B (an eye doctor)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The only building in sight was a small block of yellow brick sitting on the edge of the waste land, a sort of compact Main Street ministering to it, and _____ to absolutely nothing.” Word bank: chiffon, oculist, flounced, contiguous

    Key: contiguous

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

    A. Illusion and reality

    B. Class and money

    C. The past and time

    D. The American Dream

    Key: B (Class and money)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1).

    Sample answer: Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose eyes look out from the billboard?

    A. Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's

    B. Gatsby's

    C. Wilson's

    D. Tom's

    Key: A (Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Tom do when Myrtle says Daisy's name?

    A. Leaves

    B. Breaks her nose

    C. Apologizes

    D. Laughs

Key: B (Breaks her nose)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Myrtle buy on the way to the apartment?

    A. A ring

    B. A dress only

    C. A dog

    D. A car

    Key: C (A dog)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 2: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and _____”

    Key: gigantic

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter II”? The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Irony

    C. Setting

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Setting)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does Nick stay at the party although he wants to leave?

    Sample answer: His fascination and passivity: 'within and without'. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) — The billboard eyes. This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He was a blond, spiritless man, _____, and faintly handsome.” Word bank: chiffon, oculist, flounced, anaemic

    Key: anaemic

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The billboard eyes. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Myrtle a victim, a social climber, or both? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence: the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The billboard eyes. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words “gigantic” and “blue” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words “valley” and “ashes” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1)
A. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.
B. Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.
C. Wilson on the eyes.
D. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.
Key: A (The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 31: “In a basket swung from his neck cowered a dozen very recent puppies of an _____ breed.” Word bank: immediately, somewhere, indeterminate, drawbridge
Key: indeterminate

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 49 reveal about the character or situation? “We went on, cutting back again over the Park toward the West Hundreds.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Chapter II, paragraph 49) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words “cutting” and “toward” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: “Then she wet her lips, and without turning around spoke to her husband in a soft, coarse voice:” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “without” and “turning” (Chapter II, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: “The supercilious assumption was that on Sunday afternoon I had nothing better to do.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “supercilious” and “assumption” (Chapter II, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 68 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “Get some more ice and mineral water, Myrtle, before everybody goes to sleep.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter II, paragraph 68) develops the past and time: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Its words “everybody” and “mineral” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Well, they say he’s a nephew or a cousin of Kaiser Wilhelm’s.” (Chapter II, paragraph 81), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 34 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “I’d like to get one of those police dogs; I don’t suppose you got that kind?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter II, paragraph 34) develops the past and time: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Its words “suppose” and “police” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The Airedale—undoubtedly there was an Airedale concerned in it somewhere, though its feet were startlingly…” (Chapter II, paragraph 40), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter II, paragraph 28? “Tom deferred that much to the _____ of those East Eggers who might be on the train.”

    A. torpedoes

    B. sensuously

    C. sensibilities

    D. indeterminate

    Key: C (sensibilities)

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 51 shapes its tone: “Looked at from a distance, however, the hen resolved itself into a bonnet, and the countenance of a stout old lady beamed down into the room.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “countenance” and “distance” (Chapter II, paragraph 51) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 29 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “She had changed her dress to a brown figured muslin, which stretched tight over her rather wide hips as Tom helped her to the platform in New York.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter II, paragraph 29) develops carelessness and morality: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Its words “stretched” and “platform” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Upstairs, in the solemn echoing drive she let four taxicabs drive away before she selected a new one, lavender-coloured…” (Chapter II, paragraph 29), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter II, paragraph 57 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “I had a woman up here last week to look at my feet, and when she gave me the bill you’d of thought she had my appendicitis out.” Use one other moment from

the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter II, paragraph 57) develops carelessness and morality: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Its words “appendicitis” and “thought” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “If Chester could only get you in that pose I think he could make something of it.” (Chapter II, paragraph 63), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 17, 8, 5, 18, 19, 20, 2, 21, 10, 12, 11, 22, 14, 23, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 8, 25, 1, 9, 20, 26, 27, 10, 12, 11, 28, 23, 15, 16, 29	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 9, 18, 5, 30, 11, 31, 10, 13, 12, 15, 14, 28, 22, 16, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 5, 30, 4, 8, 13, 11, 10, 12, 15, 22, 14, 28, 29, 33, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 26, 21, 18, 19, 12, 10, 11, 28, 15, 22, 14, 32, 16, 34, 29	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 2, 19, 6, 35, 11, 31, 12, 10, 28, 22, 14, 15, 32, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	18, 36, 17, 5, 37, 10, 23, 22, 38, 15, 39, 40, 41, 16, 32, 29	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 4, 19, 6, 11, 10, 13, 12, 28, 15, 14, 22, 16, 32, 33, 29	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	42, 17, 21, 5, 14, 28, 15, 43, 38, 16, 33, 40, 41, 44, 34, 45	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	2, 17, 21, 5, 35, 22, 43, 15, 29, 16, 32, 41, 40, 44, 33, 45	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter II,” how does Fitzgerald show the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter II, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses setting in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *Then she flounced over to the dog, kissed it with ecstasy, and swept into the kitchen, implying that a dozen chefs awaited her orders there.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "flounced" most nearly mean?

   A. acting like an owner; possessive
   B. moved with quick, showy, impatient movements
   C. pale and lacking energy (British spelling of anemic)
   D. in a way that can be understood more than one way

2. *But above the grey land and the spasms of bleak dust which drift endlessly over it, you perceive, after a moment, the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic—their retinas are one yard high. They look out of no face, but, instead, from a pair of enormous yellow spectacles which pass over a nonexistent nose. Evidently some wild wag of an oculist set them there to fatten his practice in the borough of Queens, and then sank down himself into eternal blindness, or forgot them and moved away. But his eyes, dimmed a little by many paintless days, under sun and rain, brood on over the solemn dumping ground.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter II"?

   A. The reunion
   B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans
   C. The funeral and the meaning of the dream
   D. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

SAT key: 1. B (moved with quick, showy, impatient movements); 2. D (The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party)

Lesson 4: Chapter III

Focus: Gatsby's party

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Chapter III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “The sentences roll along smoothly, sparklingly, variously. There is evidence in every line of hard and intelligent effort.” (H. L. Mencken, critic and journalist, *Review of The Great Gatsby, Chicago Sunday Tribune (3 May 1925), reprinted as "Time Machine" (10 Oct 2014), section "Profiting by Criticism"*; public domain). Imitation exercise: write one "sparkling" sentence describing a modern party in Fitzgerald's manner. *Objective:* Analyze Fitzgerald's prose style in the party chapter. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

Content note (alcohol and drunk driving, Prohibition, suicide (figurative remark)): Gatsby's party runs on illegal alcohol, and a drunk guest wrecks a car (the wheel comes off). Give Prohibition context and discuss impaired driving as a real danger, not a joke. Jordan's 'Do you want to commit suicide?' is a flip remark about reckless driving; if students pick it up, note that we say 'die by suicide' and point to support.
Student preview: This chapter shows heavy drinking at a party and a drunk-driving accident.
Suggested language: “Why does Fitzgerald end the party with a car accident?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring smile and 'old sport.' Gatsby speaks privately with Jordan. Leaving, guests see a car wreck in the ditch. Nick describes his own ordinary life and his friendship with Jordan, who lies and is a careless driver.

Background: During Prohibition (1920–1933) alcohol flowed at private parties; jazz orchestras, cocktails and new dances were features of the age.

Significance: The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to illusion and reality because.... Content note before we start: This chapter shows heavy drinking at a party and a drunk-driving accident. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to illusion and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: chauffeurs — people paid to drive a private car; hydroplane — a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water; lurches — moves suddenly and unsteadily; saxophones — brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz; caterwauling — making a loud, harsh, wailing noise.
Words: chauffeurs: people paid to drive a private car · hydroplane: a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water · lurches: moves suddenly and unsteadily · saxophones: brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz · caterwauling: making a loud, harsh, wailing noise

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
During Prohibition (1920–1933) alcohol flowed at private parties; jazz orchestras, cocktails and new dances were features of the age. The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns. Imagery: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars." Characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Irony: Guests gossip about Gatsby (he killed a man, he was a German spy) while drinking his liquor. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "of faces and voices and colour under the constantly changing light" (Chapter III, paragraph 5).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick describes Gatsby's smile as rare and as giving eternal reassurance. Next, craft. I notice the extreme words "rare" and "eternal," which make the smile sound almost magical. The strongest word is "reassurance": it means comfort that you are believed in, exactly what Nick feels. Then, effect. What does Gatsby's smile do to the person who receives it? My answer: Gatsby's smile makes the person who receives it feel understood and believed in; Nick is drawn in, and we see how Gatsby can create the image people want.

> *It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it (Chapter III, paragraph 76)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick describes Gatsby's smile as rare and as giving eternal reassurance. Next, craft. I notice the extreme words "rare" and "eternal," which make the smile sound almost magical. The strongest word is "reassurance": it means comfort that you are believed in, exactly what Nick feels. Then, effect. What does Gatsby's smile do to the person who receives it? My answer: Gatsby's smile makes the person who receives it feel understood and believed in; Nick is drawn in, and we see how Gatsby can create the image people want.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Moths fly to light and are burned. Expected link: illusion and reality; the guests are drawn to Gatsby's glitter. Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality? Expected: The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. (The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.)

> *In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars (Chapter III, paragraph 1)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Moths fly to light and are burned. Expected link: illusion and reality; the guests are drawn to Gatsby's glitter.
Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality?
Expected answer: The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. (The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. When the text says "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

Task: Annotate the chapter for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. When the text says "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them? Ask: should we trust Nick's claim to honesty after this chapter?

Anchor question: What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?

Facilitation: Ask: should we trust Nick's claim to honesty after this chapter?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. ("In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars", Chapter III, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. ("In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars", Chapter III, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes Gatsby's party. Key takeaway: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars."
- **Characterization:** Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport."
- **Irony:** Guests gossip about Gatsby (he killed a man, he was a German spy) while drinking his liquor.

Themes and how they develop

- **illusion and reality:** the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “of faces and voices and colour under the constantly changing light” (Chapter III, paragraph 5).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “She narrowed her eyes and shivered. Lucille shivered. We all turned and looked around for” (Chapter III, paragraph 36).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.
- “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76) Gatsby's charm.
- “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171) Nick's self-assessment.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections.
Evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet

their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chauffeurs (noun)	people paid to drive a private car	*The sharp jut of a wall accounted for the detachment of the wheel, which was now getting considerable attention from half a dozen curious chauffeurs.*	
hydroplane (noun)	a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water	*Evidently he lived in this vicinity, for he told me that he had just bought a hydroplane, and was going to try it out in the morning.*	
lurches (verb)	moves suddenly and unsteadily	*The lights grow brighter as the earth lurches away from the sun, and now the orchestra is playing yellow cocktail music, and the opera of voices pitches a key higher.*	
saxophones (noun)	brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz	*By seven o'clock the orchestra has arrived, no thin five-piece affair, but a whole pitful of oboes and trombones and saxophones and viols and cornets and piccolos, and low and high drums.*	
caterwauling (adjective)	making a loud, harsh, wailing noise	*The caterwauling horns had reached a crescendo and I turned away and cut across the lawn toward home.*	
tactfully (adverb)	carefully, so as not to upset anyone	*Nevertheless there was a vague understanding that had to be tactfully broken off before I was free.*	
permeate (verb)	to spread through every part of	*The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails permeate the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each other's names.*	
harlequin (adjective)	in a pattern of bright, many-coloured diamonds or patches	*On buffet tables, garnished with glistening hors-d'oeuvre, spiced baked hams crowded against salads of harlequin designs and pastry pigs and turkeys bewitched to a dark gold.*	
affectations (noun)	manners put on to impress, not natural	*The bored haughty face that she turned to the world concealed something—most affectations conceal something eventually, even though they don't in the beginning—and one day I found what it was.*	
innuendo (noun)	hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly	*The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails permeate the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each other's names.*	

Discussion questions

1. What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the past and time?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who among the guests has actually been invited? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Very few; most just come.
2. What does Jordan tell Nick about her talk with Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Something 'the most amazing'; she can't tell yet.
3. How is Nick invited? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A formal note delivered by a chauffeur
4. What surprises the owl-eyed man? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The books are real
5. What does Gatsby call people? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Old sport
6. What happens as guests leave? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A car crashes into a ditch
7. What does Nick say about Jordan's honesty? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is incurably dishonest
8. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring smile and 'old sport.' Gatsby speaks privately with Jordan. Leaving, guests see a car wreck in the…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter III”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does “Chapter III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why are the rumours about Gatsby so wild? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: His mystery invites projection.
2. What do the car wreck and Jordan's driving suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Carelessness that will later kill.
3. What does “Chapter III” suggest about Gatsby's party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.
4. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
5. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “At least once a fortnight a corps of caterers came down with several hundred feet of canvas and enough coloured lights to make a Christmas tree of Gatsby’s enormous garden.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring…
8. How does “Chapter III” build on “Chapter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. The bell-ringer asked: “What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Gatsby's party joyful or empty? Use details. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation of the imagery.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Does Nick's claim 'I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known' convince you? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to illusion and reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. On imagery: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter III” treats Gatsby's party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people

without making real connections. Useful evidence: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter III, paragraph 171: "I am one of the few _____ people that I have ever known"
   Key: honest
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter III, paragraph 1: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the _____ and the champagne and the stars"
   Key: whisperings
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The lights grow brighter as the earth lurches away from the sun, and now the orchestra is playing yellow cocktail music, and the opera of voices pitches a key higher.", what does "lurches" most nearly mean?
   A. a prison
   B. to confirm that something is true
   C. for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket)
   D. moves suddenly and unsteadily

   Key: D (moves suddenly and unsteadily)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Evidently he lived in this vicinity, for he told me that he had just bought a hydroplane, and was going to try it out in the morning.", what does "hydroplane" most nearly mean?
   A. dull, without shine
   B. fragrant yellow flowers related to the daffodil
   C. in a showy, too-bright way
   D. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

   Key: D (a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On buffet tables, garnished with glistening hors-d'oeuvre, spiced baked hams crowded against salads of _____ designs and pastry pigs and turkeys bewitched to a dark gold." Word bank: harlequin, hydroplane, chauffeurs, lurches
   Key: harlequin
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is Nick invited?
   A. By Daisy

B. He is not invited

C. A formal note delivered by a chauffeur

D. By phone

Key: C (A formal note delivered by a chauffeur)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter III, paragraph 76: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal _____ in it”

   Key: reassurance

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby call people?

   A. Old sport

   B. Mate

   C. My friend

   D. Sir

   Key: A (Old sport)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The _____ horns had reached a crescendo and I turned away and cut across the lawn toward home.” Word bank: lurches, chauffeurs, caterwauling, hydroplane

   Key: caterwauling

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The sharp jut of a wall accounted for the detachment of the wheel, which was now getting considerable attention from half a dozen curious chauffeurs.”, what does “chauffeurs” most nearly mean?

    A. the quality of giving off light; brightness

    B. by imagining someone else's experience rather than having it oneself

    C. lost for good; impossible to get back

    D. people paid to drive a private car

    Key: D (people paid to drive a private car)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What do the car wreck and Jordan's driving suggest?

    Sample answer: Carelessness that will later kill: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

    A. Gatsby's party

    B. The reunion

    C. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

    D. The Plaza and the death car

    Key: A (Gatsby's party)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why are the rumours about Gatsby so wild?

    Sample answer: His mystery invites projection: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter III”? Gatsby's party in sensory overload: ‘In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars.’

    A. Imagery

    B. Structure

    C. Plot

    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Imagery)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter III”? Gatsby's smile, ‘one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it,’ and his formal ‘old sport.’

    A. Characterization

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Symbolism

    D. Theme

    Key: A (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how illusion and reality develops from Chapter II to Chapter III. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter II, paragraph 1, the text reads “This is a valley of ashes”, which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. In Chapter III, “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1), which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Nick say about Jordan's honesty?

    A. She is wise

    B. She is shy

    C. She never lies

    D. She is incurably dishonest

    Key: D (She is incurably dishonest)

18. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jordan tell Nick about her talk with Gatsby?

    Sample answer: Something 'the most amazing'; she can't tell yet.

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Nevertheless there was a vague understanding that had to be _____ broken off before I was free.” Word bank: hydroplane, lurches, chauffeurs, tactfully

    Key: tactfully

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Nick's self-assessment. The evidence is “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “people” and “honest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

    A. The American Dream

    B. Class and money

    C. Illusion and reality

    D. The past and time

    Key: C (Illusion and reality)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Gatsby's party joyful or empty? Use details.

    Sample answer: An evaluation of the imagery: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What happens as guests leave?

    A. A fight breaks out

    B. Gatsby gives a speech

    C. A car crashes into a ditch

    D. It rains

    Key: C (A car crashes into a ditch)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does Nick's claim 'I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known' convince you?

    Sample answer: A reasoned judgment: Nick's self-assessment. The evidence is “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What surprises the owl-eyed man?

    A. Gatsby is young

    B. The champagne

    C. The orchestra

    D. The books are real

    Key: D (The books are real)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails _____ the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each…” Word bank: chauffeurs, lurches, permeate, hydroplane

    Key: permeate

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's charm. The evidence is “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “reassurance” and “quality” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

    Sample answer: Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1), which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “There was a machine in the kitchen which could extract the juice of two hundred oranges in half an hour if a little button was pressed two hundred times by a butler’s thumb.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter III, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “extract” and “machine” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 40 reveal about the character or situation? “The bar, where we glanced first, was crowded, but Gatsby was not there.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter III, paragraph 40) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “glanced” and “crowded” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 60 shapes its tone: “I had taken two finger-bowls of champagne, and the scene had changed before my eyes into something significant, elemental, and profound.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “significant” and “something” (Chapter III, paragraph 60) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “Sometimes they came and went without having met Gatsby at all, came for the party with a simplicity of heart that was its own ticket of admission.” Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “simplicity” and “admission” (Chapter III, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 36 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “It was testimony to the romantic speculation he inspired that there were whispers about him from those who had found little that it was necessary to whisper about in this world.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter III, paragraph 36) develops the past and time: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Its words “speculation” and “testimony” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There were three married couples and Jordan’s escort, a persistent undergraduate given to violent innuendo, and…” (Chapter III, paragraph 37), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 77 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “He excused himself with a small bow that included each of us in turn.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter III, paragraph 77) develops carelessness and morality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Its words “included” and “himself” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I had expected that Mr. Gatsby would be a florid and corpulent person in his middle years.” (Chapter III, paragraph 79), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “A tray of cocktails floated at us through the twilight, and we sat down at a table with the two girls in yellow and three men, each one introduced to us as Mr. Mumble.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter III, paragraph 19) develops carelessness and morality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Its words “introduced” and “cocktails” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “When I was here last I tore my gown on a chair, and he asked me my name and address—inside of a week I got a package…” (Chapter III, paragraph 23), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 88 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “I would have accepted without question the information that Gatsby sprang from the swamps of Louisiana or from the lower East Side of New York.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter III, paragraph 88) develops the past and time: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Its words “information” and “accepted” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There was the boom of a bass drum, and the voice of the orchestra leader rang out suddenly above the echolalia of the…” (Chapter III, paragraph 90), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “By seven o’clock the orchestra has arrived, no thin five-piece affair, but a whole pitful of oboes and trombones and saxophones and viols and cornets and piccolos, and low and high drums.”, what does “saxophones” most nearly mean?

A. moves suddenly and unsteadily

B. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz

C. people paid to drive a private car

D. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

Key: B (brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz)

39. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter III, paragraph 19? “With Jordan’s slender golden arm resting in mine, we _____ the steps and sauntered about the garden.”

A. explained

B. introduced

C. surprisingly

D. descended

Key: D (descended)

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “They were at least agonizingly aware of the easy money in the vicinity and convinced that it was theirs for a few words in the right key.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “agonizingly” and “convinced” (Chapter III, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter III, paragraph 51 shapes its tone: “He snatched the book from me and replaced it hastily on its shelf, muttering that if one brick was removed the whole library was liable to collapse.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “muttering” and “collapse” (Chapter III, paragraph 51) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “whisperings” and “champagne” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	10, 17, 8, 18, 1, 6, 19, 3, 7, 12, 11, 13, 15, 14, 20, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 8, 7, 6, 17, 3, 5, 19, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 21, 22, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	4, 5, 9, 18, 23, 19, 7, 12, 11, 13, 14, 15, 20, 21, 24, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 4, 8, 25, 10, 26, 11, 13, 12, 21, 15, 14, 20, 22, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 26, 17, 8, 12, 11, 27, 13, 20, 21, 15, 14, 16, 22, 24, 28	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 19, 23, 17, 6, 11, 13, 12, 14, 15, 20, 21, 29, 24, 22, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	6, 9, 19, 12, 30, 31, 32, 33, 21, 14, 20, 34, 35, 16, 36, 37	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	38, 39, 9, 19, 27, 14, 40, 33, 21, 32, 34, 37, 16, 35, 22, 24	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	39, 9, 19, 6, 40, 15, 41, 21, 33, 36, 34, 22, 28, 16, 37, 35	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	9, 19, 6, 25, 12, 14, 20, 32, 35, 24, 37, 28, 34, 22, 42, 36	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter III,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Chapter III, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about Gatsby's party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses imagery in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's party. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's party follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of Gatsby's party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's party. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *The lights grow brighter as the earth lurches away from the sun, and now the orchestra is playing yellow cocktail music, and the opera of voices pitches a key higher.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “lurches” most nearly mean?

   A. moves suddenly and unsteadily

   B. manners put on to impress, not natural

   C. hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly

   D. in a pattern of bright, many-coloured diamonds or patches

2. *At least once a fortnight a corps of caterers came down with several hundred feet of canvas and enough coloured lights to make a Christmas tree of Gatsby’s enormous garden. On buffet tables, garnished with glistening hors-d’oeuvre, spiced baked hams crowded against salads of harlequin designs and pastry pigs and turkeys bewitched to a dark gold. In the main hall a bar with a real brass rail was set up, and stocked with gins and liquors and with cordials so long forgotten that most of his female guests were too young to know one from another.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

   A. The reunion

   B. James Gatz and the second party

C. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

D. Gatsby's party

SAT key: 1. A (moves suddenly and unsteadily); 2. D (Gatsby's party)

Lesson 5: Chapter IV

Focus: Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Chapter IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “In the method of telling, "The Great Gatsby" is reminiscent of Henry James's "Turn of the Screw." You will recall that the evil of that mysterious tale which so endangered the two children was never exactly stated beyond suggested generalization. Gatsby's fortune, business, even his connection with underworld figures, remain vague generalizations.” (Edwin Clark, reviewer, *"Scott Fitzgerald Looks Into Middle Age," The New York Times Book Review (19 April 1925), paragraph 3*; public domain). Narrator reliability: why does Nick withhold or not know Gatsby's business? List what Chapter IV states vs. suggests (Wolfsheim). *Objective:* Analyze Nick's narration and the mystery of Gatsby's story. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.6, RL.11-12.5

Content note (racist narration, antisemitic stereotyping (narration), suicide (reported), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Nick himself describes a car of Black passengers with racist language and caricature ('two bucks and a girl'), and draws Wolfshiem with antisemitic stereotypes. These are the narrator's words, not a villain's. Do not read the slurs aloud; discuss how they complicate Nick's claim to reserve judgment. Nick's list of party guests mentions, in a single clause, that one guest (Henry L. Palmetto) later died by suicide. It is said in passing; acknowledge it briefly, use the safe-messaging script, and do not read out or discuss how he died. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…id the young ladies, moving somewhere between his cocktails and his flowers. “One time he killed a…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: The narrator uses racist and antisemitic stereotypes in this chapter. A guest list mentions a man who died by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What does this description reveal about Nick as a narrator?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she married Tom in 1919 after a night of crying over a letter. Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy and wants Nick to invite her to tea.

Background: The 1919 World Series fix (the Black Sox scandal) was a real event. Camp Taylor near Louisville trained officers in 1917–18.

Significance: The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone invent a past? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the American Dream because.... Content note before we start: The narrator uses racist and antisemitic stereotypes in this chapter. A guest list mentions a man who died by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Why might someone invent a past?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the American Dream because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: penitentiary — a prison; knickerbockers — loose short trousers gathered just below the knee; terraced — built up in rising layers or rows; outstay — stay longer than (is wanted); sporadic — happening in irregular bursts, not steadily.
Words: penitentiary: a prison · knickerbockers: loose short trousers gathered just below the knee · terraced: built up in rising layers or rows · outstay: stay longer than (is wanted) · sporadic: happening in irregular bursts, not steadily

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The 1919 World Series fix (the Black Sox scandal) was a real event. Camp Taylor near Louisville trained officers in 1917–18. The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy. Characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Symbolism: The green light reinterpreted: Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "down behind many layers of glass in a sort of green leather conservatory, we started to town" (Chapter IV, paragraph 17).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" slowly and put it in my own words: Gatsby tells Nick he is the son of wealthy Midwestern people who are all dead. Next, craft. I notice the dash before "all dead now," like a detail added too quickly to stop questions. The strongest word is "wealthy": it is the word he most needs us to believe, and it is false. Then, effect. Why does Gatsby's claim make Nick doubt him? My answer: The quick, rehearsed claim shows Gatsby is inventing a respectable past; Nick and the reader begin to suspect the story.

> *I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now (Chapter IV, paragraph 24)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" slowly and put it in my own words: Gatsby tells Nick he is the son of wealthy Midwestern people who are all dead. Next, craft. I notice the dash before "all dead now," like a detail added too quickly to stop questions. The strongest word is "wealthy": it is the word he most needs us to believe, and it is false. Then, effect. Why does Gatsby's claim make Nick doubt him? My answer: The quick, rehearsed claim shows Gatsby is inventing a respectable past; Nick and the reader begin to suspect the story.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nick divides people into pursued, pursuing, busy and tired. Expected link: the American Dream; Gatsby is the pursuer. Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream? Expected: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. (Nick's summing-up.)

> *There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired (Chapter IV, paragraph 166)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Nick divides people into pursued, pursuing, busy and tired. Expected link: the American Dream; Gatsby is the pursuer.
Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream?
Expected answer: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. (Nick's summing-up.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. When the text says "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), it shows this directly. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. When the text says "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), it shows this directly. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone invent a past? Ask: does knowing Gatsby's motive make him more or less admirable?
Anchor question: Why might someone invent a past?
Facilitation: Ask: does knowing Gatsby's motive make him more or less admirable?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. ("Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay", Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. ("Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay", Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Key takeaway: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world.
- **Structure:** Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville.
- **Symbolism:** The green light reinterpreted: Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy.

Themes and how they develop

- **the American Dream:** Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “down behind many layers of glass in a sort of green leather conservatory, we started to town” (Chapter IV, paragraph 17).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “I see” (Chapter IV, paragraph 28).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) Gatsby's invented past.
- “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) Wolfshiem.
- “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153) The reason for everything.
- “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166) Nick's summing-up.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal.
Evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153)
Reasoning: His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
penitentiary (noun)	a prison	*Snell was there three days before he went to the penitentiary, so drunk out on the gravel drive that Mrs.*	
knickerbockers (noun)	loose short trousers gathered just below the knee	*He came only once, in white knickerbockers, and had a fight with a bum named Etty in the garden.*	
terraced (adjective)	built up in rising layers or rows	*It was a rich cream colour, bright with nickel, swollen here and there in its monstrous length with triumphant hatboxes and supper-boxes and toolboxes, and terraced with a labyrinth of windshields that mirrored a dozen suns.*	
outstay (verb)	stay longer than (is wanted)	*"I have enjoyed my lunch," he said, "and I'm going to run off from you two young men before I outstay my welcome."*	
sporadic (adjective)	happening in irregular bursts, not steadily	*He was balancing himself on the dashboard of his car with that resourcefulness of movement that is so peculiarly American—that comes, I suppose, with the absence of lifting work in youth and, even more, with the formless grace of our nervous, sporadic games.*	
evasions (noun)	ways of dodging a question without really answering	*A little overwhelmed, I began the generalized evasions which that question deserves.*	
succulent (adjective)	juicy and tasty	*A succulent hash arrived, and Mr.*	
disconcerting (adjective)	unsettling; causing confusion	*And then came that disconcerting ride.*	
benediction (noun)	a blessing given with a raised hand	*Wolfshiem raised his hand in a sort of benediction.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone invent a past?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with illusion and reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Wolfshiem wear as cuff buttons? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Human molars.
2. When did Daisy marry Tom? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: June 1919.
3. What does Gatsby claim about his family? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead
4. Who is Meyer Wolfshiem? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A gambler who fixed the World Series
5. Where did Daisy meet Gatsby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Louisville
6. Why did Gatsby buy his house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To be across the bay from Daisy
7. What does Gatsby want from Nick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To invite Daisy to tea
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she married Tom in 1919 after a night of crying over a letter. Gatsby bought his house to be across the…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatsby show Nick a medal and a photograph? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To make his story believable, suggesting doubt.
2. How does Jordan's story change our view of Gatsby? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His display becomes a romantic quest.
3. What does "Chapter IV" suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.
4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the structure in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now"

(Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. On structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “Clarence Endive was from East Egg, as I remember.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she…
8. How does “Chapter IV” build on “Chapter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. On structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone invent a past?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Gatsby a romantic hero or a con man after this chapter? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Why does Fitzgerald let Jordan tell this backstory instead of Gatsby? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A view of structure and reliability.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and

fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to carelessness and morality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Compare how “Chapter IV” treats Gatsby's story and Daisy's past with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter V” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 166: “There are only the pursued, the _____, the busy, and the tired”
   Key: pursuing
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “A _____ hash arrived, and Mr.” Word bank: knickerbockers, terraced, penitentiary, succulent
   Key: succulent

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby claim about his family?

   A. Poor farmers

   B. Bankers in New York

   C. Royalty

   D. Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead

   Key: D (Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead)

4. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Wolfshiem wear as cuff buttons?

   Sample answer: Human molars.

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did Daisy meet Gatsby?

   A. Oxford

   B. Louisville

   C. Chicago

   D. New York

   Key: B (Louisville)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I have enjoyed my lunch,' he said, 'and I'm going to run off from you two young men before I outstay my welcome.", what does "outstay" most nearly mean?

   A. stay longer than (is wanted)

   B. haughty, proud manner

   C. hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly

   D. stretching out longer

   Key: A (stay longer than (is wanted))

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Snell was there three days before he went to the penitentiary, so drunk out on the gravel drive that Mrs.", what does "penitentiary" most nearly mean?

   A. hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly

   B. coming back again and again

   C. a prison

   D. acting like an owner; possessive

   Key: C (a prison)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He was balancing himself on the dashboard of his car with that resourcefulness of movement that is so peculiarly American—that comes, I suppose, with the absence of lifting work in youth and, even more, with the formless grace of our nervous, _____ games." Word bank: sporadic, knickerbockers, terraced, penitentiary

   Key: sporadic

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby want from Nick?

   A. A loan

   B. A lie

   C. To invite Daisy to tea

   D. A job

   Key: C (To invite Daisy to tea)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Wolfshiem. The evidence is “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.
11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Gatsby show Nick a medal and a photograph?
    Sample answer: To make his story believable, suggesting doubt. The evidence is “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), which shows the reason for everything.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IV”?
    A. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party
    B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans
    C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past
    D. The reunion

    Key: C (Gatsby's story and Daisy's past)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Jordan's story change our view of Gatsby?
    Sample answer: His display becomes a romantic quest. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) — Gatsby's invented past.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IV”? Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, ‘the man who fixed the World's Series,’ shows the criminal side of his world.
    A. Characterization
    B. Personification
    C. Alliteration
    D. Irony

    Key: A (Characterization)
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.
    A. Illusion and reality
    B. The past and time
    C. Class and money
    D. The American Dream

    Key: D (The American Dream)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Gatsby a romantic hero or a con man after this chapter?
    Sample answer: A reasoned position: Wolfshiem. The evidence is “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And then came that _____ ride.” Word bank: terraced, knickerbockers, penitentiary, disconcerting
    Key: disconcerting

18. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When did Daisy marry Tom?
    Sample answer: June 1919.

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 153: "Gatsby _____ that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay"
    Key: bought

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A little overwhelmed, I began the generalized _____ which that question deserves." Word bank: evasions, penitentiary, knickerbockers, terraced
    Key: evasions

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Gatsby's invented past. The evidence is "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The reason for everything. The evidence is "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words "across" and "bought" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter IV"? Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville.
    A. Conflict
    B. Structure
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Structure)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "He's the man who fixed the World's Series back in 1919" (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Wolfshiem. The evidence is "He's the man who fixed the World's Series back in 1919" (Chapter IV, paragraph 113). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words "fixed" and "back" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "It was a rich cream colour, bright with nickel, swollen here and there in its monstrous length with triumphant hatboxes and supper-boxes and toolboxes, and terraced with a labyrinth of windshields that mirrored a dozen…", what does "terraced" most nearly mean?
    A. built up in rising layers or rows
    B. touching or next to (here: next to nothing at all)
    C. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

D. pale and lacking energy (British spelling of anemic)

Key: A (built up in rising layers or rows)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how the American Dream develops from Chapter III to Chapter IV. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter III, paragraph 1, the text reads “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars”, which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. In Chapter IV, “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) — Gatsby's invented past. Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why did Gatsby buy his house?

A. For his father

B. For parties

C. To be across the bay from Daisy

D. As an investment

Key: C (To be across the bay from Daisy)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153).

Sample answer: His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.". The evidence is “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), which shows the reason for everything. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Fitzgerald let Jordan tell this backstory instead of Gatsby?

Sample answer: A view of structure and reliability. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) — Gatsby's invented past. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who is Meyer Wolfshiem?

A. A golfer

B. Daisy's father

C. A gambler who fixed the World Series

D. A senator

Key: C (A gambler who fixed the World Series)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Gatsby's invented past. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words “wealthy” and “people” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the

man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 24: “I am the son of some _____ people in the Middle West—all dead now”
    Key: wealthy

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153)
    A. The dream shrinks when reached.
    B. The reason for everything.
    C. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.
    D. First image of the green light.

    Key: B (The reason for everything.)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Chapter IV?
    A. “Reach me a rose, honey, and pour me a last drop into that there crystal glass.”
    B. “From East Egg, then, came the Chester Beckers and the Leeches, and a man named Bunsen, whom I knew at Yale, and Doctor Webster Civet, who…”
    C. “And the Ismays and the Chrysties (or rather Hubert Auerbach and Mr. Chrystie’s wife), and Edgar Beaver, whose hair, they say, turned…”
    D. “On Sunday morning while church bells rang in the villages alongshore, the world and its mistress returned to Gatsby’s house and twinkled…”

    Key: D (“On Sunday morning while church bells rang in the villages alongshore, the world and its mistress returned to Gatsby’s house and twinkled…”)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 66 shapes its tone: “Gatsby took an arm of each of us and moved forward into the restaurant, whereupon Mr. Wolfshiem swallowed a new sentence he was starting and lapsed into a somnambulatory abstraction.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “somnambulatory” and “abstraction” (Chapter IV, paragraph 66) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “And the Ismays and the Chrysties (or rather Hubert Auerbach and Mr. Chrystie’s wife), and Edgar Beaver, whose hair, they say, turned cotton-white one winter afternoon for no good reason at all.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “afternoon” and “reason” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 143 shapes its tone: “I rushed out and found her mother’s maid, and we locked the door and got her into a cold bath.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “rushed” and “locked” (Chapter IV, paragraph 143) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 131 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “I had on a new plaid skirt also that blew a little in the wind, and whenever this happened the red, white, and blue banners in front of all the houses stretched out stiff and said tut-tut-tut-tut, in a disapproving way.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IV, paragraph 131) develops the past and time: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Its words “disapproving” and “stretched” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “When I came opposite her house that morning her white roadster was beside the kerb, and she was sitting in it with a…” (Chapter IV, paragraph 133), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 90 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “Suddenly he looked at his watch, jumped up, and hurried from the room, leaving me with Mr. Wolfshiem at the table.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IV, paragraph 90) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Its words “hurried” and “leaving” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “As he shook hands and turned away his tragic nose was trembling.” (Chapter IV, paragraph 108), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 31 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “After that I lived like a young rajah in all the capitals of Europe—Paris, Venice, Rome—collecting jewels, chiefly rubies, hunting big game, painting a little, things for myself only, and trying to forget something very sad that had…” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IV, paragraph 31) develops the past and time: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Its words “collecting” and “something” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “We stayed there two days and two nights, a hundred and thirty men with sixteen Lewis guns, and when the infantry came…” (Chapter IV, paragraph 33), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 13 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “You’re having lunch with me today and I thought we’d ride up together.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IV, paragraph 13) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Its words “together” and “thought” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I don’t want you to get a wrong idea of me from all these stories you hear.” (Chapter IV, paragraph 22), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IV, paragraph 54 shapes its tone: “I was able to do the commissioner a favour once, and he sends me a Christmas card every year.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “commissioner” and “favour” (Chapter IV, paragraph 54) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1

HS Freshman	17, 1, 18, 2, 7, 19, 3, 20, 13, 11, 12, 21, 22, 15, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	25, 6, 8, 19, 9, 4, 12, 13, 11, 21, 10, 15, 14, 22, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 25, 17, 2, 8, 3, 19, 12, 11, 13, 15, 14, 23, 28, 26, 29	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 1, 27, 30, 9, 11, 10, 13, 12, 28, 14, 15, 23, 29, 31, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 20, 27, 4, 11, 12, 13, 14, 23, 15, 28, 29, 16, 26, 24, 31	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	6, 32, 8, 3, 21, 10, 12, 11, 13, 33, 14, 15, 23, 26, 16, 29	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	17, 2, 9, 3, 11, 12, 33, 21, 13, 14, 23, 15, 16, 26, 29, 24	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 20, 30, 18, 12, 13, 11, 33, 10, 21, 23, 15, 14, 29, 16, 26	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Senior	19, 8, 3, 34, 35, 36, 23, 15, 37, 29, 16, 38, 26, 39, 40, 41	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	8, 20, 33, 35, 14, 23, 15, 42, 41, 38, 16, 29, 39, 40, 31, 26	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter IV,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IV, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the

evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *It was a rich cream colour, bright with nickel, swollen here and there in its monstrous length with triumphant hatboxes and supper-boxes and toolboxes, and terraced with a labyrinth of windshields that mirrored a dozen suns.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “terraced” most nearly mean?

   A. a blessing given with a raised hand

   B. juicy and tasty

   C. unsettling; causing confusion

   D. built up in rising layers or rows

2. *Clarence Endive was from East Egg, as I remember. He came only once, in white knickerbockers, and had a fight with a bum named Etty in the garden. From farther out on the Island came the Cheadles and the O. R. P. Schraeders, and the Stonewall Jackson Abrams of Georgia, and the Fishguards and the Ripley Snells. Snell was there three days before he went to the penitentiary, so drunk out on the gravel drive that Mrs. Ulysses Swett's automobile ran over his right hand. The Dancies came, too, and S. B. Whitebait, who was well over sixty, and Maurice A. Flink, and the Hammerheads, and Beluga the tobacco importer, and Beluga's girls.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

A. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

C. The Plaza and the death car

D. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

SAT key: 1. D (built up in rising layers or rows); 2. D (Gatsby's story and Daisy's past)

Lesson 6: Chapter V

Focus: the reunion

Objective: Students will analyze how structure develops in “Chapter V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “This patient romantic hopefulness against existing conditions symbolizes Gatsby.” (Edwin Clark, reviewer, *"Scott Fitzgerald Looks Into Middle Age," The New York Times Book Review (19 April 1925), paragraph 3*; public domain). Quick-write: find the moment in Chapter V when "existing conditions" intrude on Gatsby's hope (the clock, the rain, the shirts). *Objective:* Analyze Gatsby's romantic hope at the reunion. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (adultery): Nick arranges the reunion of Gatsby and the married Daisy; the affair develops over Chapters V–VII. Keep discussion on longing and the past.
Student preview: This chapter begins an affair between Gatsby and a married woman.
Suggested language: “What does Gatsby want from the reunion?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer plays the piano. Nick leaves them together, sensing that Daisy cannot match Gatsby's dream.

Background: Imported English shirts and mansions copying European styles were status symbols for the newly rich.

Significance: The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to illusion and reality because.... Content note before we start: This chapter begins an affair between Gatsby and a married woman.
Prompt: What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to illusion and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tactlessly — without care for others' feelings; awkwardly; gaudily — in a showy, too-bright way; monograms — designs made of a person's initials; recurrent — coming back again and again; disarray — an untidy, disordered state. “monograms”: Origin of “monogram”: French monogramme. “disarray”: Origin: Middle English disareyen (“to disarray”); earlier Old French desareer.
Words: tactlessly: without care for others' feelings; awkwardly · gaudily: in a showy, too-bright way · monograms: designs made of a person's initials · recurrent: coming back again and again · disarray: an untidy, disordered state

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Imported English shirts and mansions copying European styles were status symbols for the newly rich. The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.' Structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Symbolism: Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display. Imagery: The green light's "colossal significance" vanishes once Daisy is near. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints” (Chapter V, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “They’re such beautiful shirts” slowly and put it in my own words: Daisy cries over Gatsby's shirts, saying they are so beautiful. Next, craft. I notice how strange it is: she weeps over clothing, not over Gatsby himself. The strongest word is “beautiful”: it is a vague word that shows she is moved by beauty and wealth. Then, effect. What does Daisy's response to the shirts show? My answer: Daisy's response to the shirts, weeping over them, shows she is overwhelmed by Gatsby's wealth and by what she lost; her tears hint that she values things as much as the man.

> *They’re such beautiful shirts (Chapter V, paragraph 118)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “They’re such beautiful shirts” slowly and put it in my own words: Daisy cries over Gatsby's shirts, saying they are so beautiful. Next, craft. I notice how strange it is: she weeps over clothing, not over Gatsby himself. The strongest word is “beautiful”: it is a vague word that shows she is moved by beauty and wealth. Then, effect. What does Daisy's response to the shirts show? My answer: Daisy's response to the shirts, weeping over them, shows she is overwhelmed by Gatsby's wealth and by what she lost; her tears hint that she values things as much as the man.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Once Daisy is beside him, the light is only a light. Expected link: illusion and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality? Expected: No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." (The dream shrinks when reached.)

> *the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever* (Chapter V, paragraph 121)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Once Daisy is beside him, the light is only a light. Expected link: illusion and reality.
Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality?
Expected answer: No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." (The dream shrinks when reached.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. When the text says “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), it shows this directly. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. When the text says “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), it shows this directly. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time? Ask: why does Daisy cry over the shirts?
Anchor question: What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Daisy cry over the shirts?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. ("the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever", Chapter V, paragraph 121). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. ("the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever", Chapter V, paragraph 121). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the reunion. Key takeaway: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.
- **Symbolism:** Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display.
- **Imagery:** The green light's "colossal significance" vanishes once Daisy is near.

Themes and how they develop

- **illusion and reality:** no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints" (Chapter V, paragraph 1).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "Does it?" He turned his eyes toward it absently. "I have been glancing into some of the" (Chapter V, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118) Daisy's tears over the shirts.
- "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121) The dream shrinks when reached.

- "There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams" (Chapter V, paragraph 151) Reality versus illusion.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself.
Evidence: "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121)
Reasoning: Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tactlessly (adverb)	without care for others' feelings; awkwardly	*But, because the offer was obviously and tactlessly for a service to be rendered, I had no choice except to cut him off there.*	
gaudily (adverb)	in a showy, too-bright way	*So I don't know whether or not Gatsby went to Coney Island, or for how many hours he "glanced into rooms" while his house blazed gaudily on.*	
monograms (noun)	designs made of a person's initials	*While we admired he brought more and the soft rich heap mounted higher—shirts with stripes and scrolls and plaids in coral and apple-green and lavender and faint orange, with monograms of indian blue.*	"monograms": Origin of "monogram": French monogramme. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/monogram#Etymology)
recurrent (adjective)	coming back again and again	*When he realized what I was talking about, that there were twinkle-bells of sunshine in the room, he smiled like a weather man, like an ecstatic patron of recurrent light, and repeated the news to Daisy.*	
disarray (noun)	an untidy, disordered state	*He took out a pile of shirts and began throwing them, one by one, before us, shirts of sheer linen and thick silk and fine flannel, which lost their folds as they fell and covered the table in many-coloured disarray.*	"disarray": Origin: Middle English disareyen ("to disarray"); earlier Old French desareer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disarray#Etymology)
defunct (adjective)	no longer working	*His head leaned back so far that it rested against the face of a defunct mantelpiece clock, and from this position his distraught eyes stared down at Daisy, who*	

		was sitting, frightened but graceful, on the edge of a stiff chair.	
obstinate (adjective)	stubbornly refusing to change	*Americans, while willing, even eager, to be serfs, have always been obstinate about being peasantry.*	
elongating (adjective)	stretching out longer	*Two o'clock and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints upon the roadside wires.*	
stormily (adverb)	with violent, wild emotion	*Suddenly, with a strained sound, Daisy bent her head into the shirts and began to cry stormily.*	
jonquils (noun)	fragrant yellow flowers related to the daffodil	*With enchanting murmurs Daisy admired this aspect or that of the feudal silhouette against the sky, admired the gardens, the sparkling odour of jonquils and the frothy odour of hawthorn and plum blossoms and the pale gold odour of kiss-me-at-the-gate.*	

Discussion questions

1. What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with carelessness and morality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Gatsby do to Nick's lawn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sends a man to cut it.
2. What did Gatsby keep about Daisy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Newspaper clippings.
3. Where does the reunion take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nick's house

4. What is the weather during the reunion? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rain
5. What makes Daisy cry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby's shirts
6. Who plays the piano? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Klipspringer
7. What nearly falls during the awkward meeting? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A clock
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer plays the piano. Nick leaves them together, sensing that Daisy cannot match Gatsby's dream.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter V"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the near-falling clock matter? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Gatsby tries to stop time; it is a symbol of the past.
2. Why does the green light lose its meaning? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Daisy is near; the symbol becomes an object.
3. What does "Chapter V" suggest about the reunion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'
4. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the reunion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. On symbolism: Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "When I came home to West Egg that night I was afraid for a moment that my house was on fire.", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer…
8. How does “Chapter V” build on “Chapter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. On structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Can any real person match a five-year dream? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Is Gatsby's display of wealth love or performance? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy

tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter V” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the reunion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the American Dream: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. On structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter V” treats the reunion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter VI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter V, paragraph 121: “the colossal _____ of that light had now vanished forever”

   Key: significance

2. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Gatsby keep about Daisy?

   Sample answer: Newspaper clippings.

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “His head leaned back so far that it rested against the face of a _____ mantelpiece clock, and from this position his distraught eyes stared down at Daisy, who was sitting, frightened but graceful, on the edge of a stiff chair.”

   Word bank: tactlessly, gaudily, defunct, monograms

   Key: defunct

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does the reunion take place?

   A. Daisy's house

   B. The Plaza

   C. Nick's house

   D. Gatsby's mansion

   Key: C (Nick's house)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He took out a pile of shirts and began throwing them, one by one, before us, shirts of sheer linen and thick silk and fine

flannel, which lost their folds as they fell and covered the table in many-coloured _____." Word bank: gaudily, tactlessly, disarray, monograms

Key: disarray

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who plays the piano?

   A. Wolfshiem

   B. Jordan

   C. Nick

   D. Klipspringer

   Key: D (Klipspringer)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Americans, while willing, even eager, to be serfs, have always been _____ about being peasantry." Word bank: obstinate, tactlessly, gaudily, monograms

   Key: obstinate

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "But, because the offer was obviously and tactlessly for a service to be rendered, I had no choice except to cut him off there.", what does "tactlessly" most nearly mean?

   A. making a loud, harsh, wailing noise

   B. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

   C. without care for others' feelings; awkwardly

   D. hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly

   Key: C (without care for others' feelings; awkwardly)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Two o'clock and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin _____ glints upon the roadside wires." Word bank: gaudily, monograms, elongating, tactlessly

   Key: elongating

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the green light lose its meaning?

    Sample answer: Daisy is near; the symbol becomes an object. The evidence is "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the near-falling clock matter?

    Sample answer: Gatsby tries to stop time; it is a symbol of the past. The evidence is "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter V"?

    A. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

    B. The reunion

    C. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

    D. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

    Key: B (The reunion)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Daisy's tears over the shirts. The evidence is "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display.

    A. Point of view

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121).

    Sample answer: Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.". The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached. This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how illusion and reality develops from Chapter III to Chapter V. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter III, paragraph 1, the text reads “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars”, which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. In Chapter V, “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) — Daisy's tears over the shirts. No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What makes Daisy cry?

    A. Gatsby's shirts

    B. Tom's call

    C. The piano

    D. A letter

    Key: A (Gatsby's shirts)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “When he realized what I was talking about, that there were twinkle-bells of sunshine in the room, he smiled like a weather man, like an ecstatic patron of recurrent light, and repeated the news to Daisy.”, what does “recurrent” most nearly mean?

    A. a prison

    B. manners put on to impress, not natural

    C. by imagining someone else's experience rather than having it oneself

    D. coming back again and again

    Key: D (coming back again and again)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “So I don’t know whether or not Gatsby went to Coney Island, or for how many hours he ‘glanced into rooms’ while his house blazed gaudily on.”, what does “gaudily” most nearly mean?

    A. moves suddenly and unsteadily

    B. complicated consequences and connections branching from something

    C. in a showy, too-bright way

    D. lost for good; impossible to get back

Key: C (in a showy, too-bright way)

20. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby do to Nick's lawn?
Sample answer: Sends a man to cut it.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Reality versus illusion. The evidence is “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “afternoon” and “tumbled” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.
A. Irony
B. Personification
C. Diction / vocabulary
D. Structure

Key: D (Structure)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Can any real person match a five-year dream? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: the dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the weather during the reunion?
A. Snow
B. Heat wave
C. Rain
D. Fog

Key: C (Rain)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? No real woman can match ‘the colossal vitality of his illusion.’
A. Illusion and reality
B. The past and time
C. The American Dream
D. Class and money

Key: A (Illusion and reality)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Daisy's tears over the shirts. The evidence is “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “beautiful” and “shirts” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick notes

that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Gatsby's display of wealth love or performance?
Sample answer: An evaluation: the dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “significance” and “vanished” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What nearly falls during the awkward meeting?

    A. A vase

    B. A glass

    C. A clock

    D. A chair

    Key: C (A clock)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “While we admired he brought more and the soft rich heap mounted higher—shirts with stripes and scrolls and plaids in coral and apple-green and lavender and faint orange, with monograms of indian blue.”, what does “monograms” most nearly mean?

    A. designs made of a person's initials

    B. forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place

    C. juicy and tasty

    D. for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket)

    Key: A (designs made of a person's initials)

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121)

    A. The dream shrinks when reached.

    B. Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.

    C. First image of the green light.

    D. Wilson on the eyes.

    Key: A (The dream shrinks when reached.)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Chapter V, paragraph 151: “There must have been moments even that _____ when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams”
Key: afternoon

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Chapter V?

    A. “As my taxi groaned away I saw Gatsby walking toward me across his lawn.”

B. “I’m going to call up Daisy tomorrow and invite her over here to tea.”

C. “At first I thought it was another party, a wild rout that had resolved itself into ‘hide-and-go-seek’ or ‘sardines-in-the-box’ with all the…”

D. “Only wind in the trees, which blew the wires and made the lights go off and on again as if the house had winked into the darkness.”

Key: C (“At first I thought it was another party, a wild rout that had resolved itself into ‘hide-and-go-seek’ or ‘sardines-in-the-box’ with all the…”)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 86 reveal about the character or situation? “A maid began opening the upper windows of his house, appeared momentarily in each, and, leaning from the large central bay, spat meditatively into the garden.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Chapter V, paragraph 86) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “meditatively” and “momentarily” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 59 shapes its tone: “Aware of the loud beating of my own heart I pulled the door to against the increasing rain.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “increasing” and “against” (Chapter V, paragraph 59) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “It wouldn’t take up much of your time and you might pick up a nice bit of money.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter V, paragraph 24) develops carelessness and morality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Its words “wouldn” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “At eleven o’clock a man in a raincoat, dragging a lawn-mower, tapped at my front door and said that Mr. Gatsby had sent…” (Chapter V, paragraph 33), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 66 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “I couldn’t muster up a single commonplace out of the thousand in my head.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter V, paragraph 66) develops carelessness and morality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Its words “commonplace” and “thousand” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The automatic quality of Gatsby’s answer set us all back at least another minute.” (Chapter V, paragraph 71), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 87 shapes its tone: “He literally glowed; without a word or a gesture of exultation a new well-being radiated from him and filled the little room.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “exultation” and “literally” (Chapter V, paragraph 87) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 49 shapes its tone: “A damp streak of hair lay like a dash of blue paint across her cheek, and her hand was wet with glistening drops as I took it to help her from the car.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “glistening” and “streak” (Chapter V, paragraph 49) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 72 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “However, as calmness wasn’t an end in itself, I made an excuse at the first possible moment, and got to my feet.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter V, paragraph 72) develops the past and time: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Its words “possible” and “calmness” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This is a terrible mistake,’ he said, shaking his head from side to side, ‘a terrible, terrible mistake.” (Chapter V, paragraph 78), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.
41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 10 shapes its tone: “I’m going to call up Daisy tomorrow and invite her over here to tea.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “tomorrow” and “invite” (Chapter V, paragraph 10) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter V, paragraph 34 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “He was pale, and there were dark signs of sleeplessness beneath his eyes.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter V, paragraph 34) develops the past and time: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Its words “sleeplessness” and “beneath” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I took him into the pantry, where he looked a little reproachfully at the Finn.” (Chapter V, paragraph 39), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 4, 17, 18, 6, 19, 20, 3, 13, 11, 10, 12, 21, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 24, 1, 3, 7, 5, 17, 9, 11, 12, 10, 14, 22, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 5, 6, 8, 17, 19, 12, 13, 11, 10, 14, 21, 22, 25, 28, 23	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 4, 1, 29, 18, 30, 12, 11, 10, 22, 25, 15, 14, 27, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 18, 7, 5, 4, 10, 31, 11, 12, 14, 22, 25, 27, 23, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Freshman	7, 32, 18, 30, 9, 11, 10, 13, 12, 14, 22, 25, 16, 27, 23, 28	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 3, 33, 12, 34, 10, 22, 21, 14, 35, 25, 36, 16, 37, 26, 23	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	29, 5, 3, 4, 33, 14, 38, 39, 35, 21, 37, 28, 23, 27, 36, 40	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	5, 3, 33, 12, 41, 38, 14, 35, 25, 42, 36, 28, 27, 40, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Graduate / PhD	4, 5, 3, 33, 25, 41, 39, 22, 23, 42, 40, 37, 26, 36, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter V,” how does Fitzgerald show the reunion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter V, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the reunion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the reunion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about the reunion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses structure in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of the reunion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the reunion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the reunion follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of the reunion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about the reunion in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the reunion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *While we admired he brought more and the soft rich heap mounted higher—shirts with stripes and scrolls and plaids in coral and apple-green and lavender and faint orange, with monograms of indian blue.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “monograms” most nearly mean?

   A. stretching out longer

   B. fragrant yellow flowers related to the daffodil

   C. with violent, wild emotion

   D. designs made of a person's initials

2. *When I came home to West Egg that night I was afraid for a moment that my house was on fire. Two o’clock and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints upon the roadside wires. Turning a corner, I saw that it was Gatsby’s house, lit from tower to cellar.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

   A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   B. The reunion

   C. Gatsby's party

   D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

SAT key: 1. D (designs made of a person's initials); 2. B (The reunion)

Lesson 7: Chapter VI

Focus: James Gatz and the second party

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Chapter VI" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…r Dan Cody sober knew what lavish doings Dan Cody drunk might soon be about, and he provided fo…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick he wants Daisy to tell Tom she never loved him and to repeat the past by marrying in Louisville.

Background: Copper and mining fortunes made men like Dan Cody rich; self-made success stories (Horatio Alger) were popular.

Significance: Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can people really reinvent themselves? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the past and time because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Can people really reinvent themselves?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the past and time because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: countered — replied in opposition; volleying — pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots; debauchee — a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures; ingratiate — to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering; ramifications — complicated consequences and connections branching from something. “debauchee”: Origin: French débauché.
Words: countered: replied in opposition · volleying: pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots · debauchee: a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures · ingratiate: to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering · ramifications: complicated consequences and connections branching from something

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Copper and mining fortunes made men like Dan Cody rich; self-made success stories (Horatio Alger) were popular. Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy. Characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Diction / vocabulary: "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation. Conflict: Tom comes to a party; Daisy is unhappy there. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “been loafing along the beach that afternoon in a torn green jersey and a pair of canvas pants, but it was already” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” slowly and put it in my own words: Nick reveals that Gatsby's legal name was James Gatz. Next, craft. I notice the cautious phrase "really, or at least legally," which questions what a real name is. The strongest word is “legally”: it separates the law's version of him from the man he invented. Then, effect. Why does Nick explain Gatsby's real name here? My answer: Gatsby is a self-made identity; the name change shows he invented himself from his "Platonic conception" of who he wanted to be.

> *James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name (Chapter VI, paragraph 6)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” slowly and put it in my own words: Nick reveals that Gatsby's legal name was James Gatz. Next, craft. I notice the cautious phrase "really, or at least legally," which questions what a real name is. The strongest word is “legally”: it separates the law's version of him from the man he invented. Then, effect. Why does Nick explain Gatsby's real name here? My answer: Gatsby is a self-made identity; the name change shows he invented himself from his "Platonic conception" of who he wanted to be.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Platonic here means an ideal form; Gatsby invented an ideal version of himself. Expected link: the American Dream. Ask: How does this line connect to the past and time? Expected: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. (Self-invention.)

> *sprang from his Platonic conception of himself* (Chapter VI, paragraph 7)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Platonic here means an ideal form; Gatsby invented an ideal version of himself. Expected link: the American Dream.
Ask: How does this line connect to the past and time?
Expected answer: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. (Self-invention.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. When the text says "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. When the text says "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can people really reinvent themselves? Ask: can anyone repeat the past?
Anchor question: Can people really reinvent themselves?
Facilitation: Ask: can anyone repeat the past?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. ("James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name", Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. ("James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name", Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes James Gatz and the second party. Key takeaway: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation.
- **Conflict:** Tom comes to a party; Daisy is unhappy there.

Themes and how they develop

- **the past and time:** Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "been loafing along the beach that afternoon in a torn green jersey and a pair of canvas pants, but it was already" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "off and with laudable initiative he had hurried out "to see" (Chapter VI, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) Gatsby's real name.
- "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself" (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) Self-invention.
- "You can't repeat the past" (Chapter VI, paragraph 128) Nick's warning.

- “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129) Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention.
Evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6)
Reasoning: Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
countered (verb)	replied in opposition	*“Then you ought to leave it alone,” countered Doctor Civet.*	
volleying (verb)	pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots	*It was dark here in front; only the bright door sent ten square feet of light volleying out into the soft black morning.*	
debauchee (noun)	a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures	*I remember the portrait of him up in Gatsby's bedroom, a grey, florid man with a hard, empty face—the pioneer debauchee, who during one phase of American life brought back to the Eastern seaboard the savage violence of the frontier brothel and saloon.*	“debauchee”: Origin: French débauché. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/debauchee#Etymology)
ingratiate (verb)	to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering	*For several weeks I didn't see him or hear his voice on the phone—mostly I was in New York, trotting around with Jordan and trying to ingratiate myself with her senile aunt—but finally I went over to his house one Sunday afternoon.*	
ramifications (noun)	complicated consequences and connections branching from something	*The none too savoury ramifications by which Ella Kaye, the newspaper woman, played Madame de Maintenon to his weakness and sent him to sea in a yacht, were common property of the turgid journalism in 1902.*	
menagerie (noun)	a strange, mixed collection		

	(literally, of wild animals)	*"Well, he certainly must have strained himself to get this menagerie together."*	
transpired (verb)	came to be known; turned out	*It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand.*	"transpired": Origin of "transpire": probably Middle French transpirer; earlier Medieval Latin transpirare ("to breathe through"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transpire#Etymology)
dilatory (adjective)	slow; causing delay	*The dilatory limousine came rolling up the drive.*	"dilatory": Origin: Old French dilatoire; earlier Latin dīlātōrius. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dilatory#Etymology)
shiftless (adjective)	lacking ambition or drive to get ahead	*His parents were shiftless and unsuccessful farm people—his imagination had never really accepted them as his parents at all.*	
elusive (adjective)	hard to catch hold of or remember	*Through all he said, even through his appalling sentimentality, I was reminded of something—an elusive rhythm, a fragment of lost words, that I had heard somewhere a long time ago.*	"elusive": Origin: Latin elusus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/elusive#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Can people really reinvent themselves?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the American Dream?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What did Gatsby inherit from Cody? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nothing; the legacy was taken by Ella Kaye.

2. Who comes with Tom to Gatsby's? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mr. Sloane and a woman.
3. What was Gatsby's real name? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: James Gatz
4. Who mentored Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dan Cody
5. Where did Gatsby grow up? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: North Dakota
6. How does Daisy feel at the party? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Uneasy and unimpressed
7. What does Gatsby want Daisy to say to Tom? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She never loved him
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick he wants Daisy to tell Tom she never loved him and to repeat the past by marrying in Louisville.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatsby insist on repeating the past? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He wants to recover himself as well as Daisy.
2. What does Daisy dislike about West Egg? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Its raw vigor and lack of polish.
3. What does "Chapter VI" suggest about James Gatz and the second party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.
4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the diction / vocabulary in this chapter shape what we understand about James Gatz and the second party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. On diction / vocabulary: "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby’s name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn’t reveal or didn’t fully understand.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick…
8. How does “Chapter VI” build on “Chapter V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Can people really reinvent themselves?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is self-invention admirable or dangerous in Gatsby's case? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned evaluation.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Should Nick have told us Gatsby's true history earlier? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An argument about structure.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about James Gatz and the second party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to class and money: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's

warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter VI” treats James Gatz and the second party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter VII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What was Gatsby's real name?
   A. James Gatz
   B. Jay Cody
   C. Gus Gatz
   D. Jim Carraway

   Key: A (James Gatz)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I remember the portrait of him up in Gatsby’s bedroom, a grey, florid man with a hard, empty face—the pioneer debauchee, who during one phase of American life brought back to the Eastern seaboard the savage violence of…”, what does “debauchee” most nearly mean?
   A. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz
   B. the quality of giving off light; brightness
   C. pale and lacking energy (British spelling of anemic)
   D. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

Key: D (a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "'Then you ought to leave it alone,' countered Doctor Civet.", what does "countered" most nearly mean?

   A. a thin, sheer, light fabric

   B. replied in opposition

   C. a prison

   D. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz

   Key: B (replied in opposition)

4. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Gatsby inherit from Cody?

   Sample answer: Nothing; the legacy was taken by Ella Kaye.

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 7: "sprang from his Platonic _____ of himself"

   Key: conception

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The none too savoury _____ by which Ella Kaye, the newspaper woman, played Madame de Maintenon to his weakness and sent him to sea in a yacht, were common property of the turgid journalism in 1902." Word bank: volleying, debauchee, countered, ramifications

   Key: ramifications

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 6: "James Gatz—that was really, or at least _____, his name"

   Key: legally

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did Gatsby grow up?

   A. Chicago

   B. Kentucky

   C. North Dakota

   D. New York

   Key: C (North Dakota)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It _____ after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand." Word bank: transpired, volleying, debauchee, countered

   Key: transpired

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Daisy dislike about West Egg?

    Sample answer: Its raw vigor and lack of polish. The evidence is "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself" (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) — Self-invention. This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Gatsby insist on repeating the past?

    Sample answer: He wants to recover himself as well as Daisy. The evidence is "Why of course you can" (Chapter VI, paragraph 129) — Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Why of course you can" (Chapter VI, paragraph 129)

    A. The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

    B. Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

C. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

D. The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.

Key: B (Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VI"?

A. Gatsby's death

B. James Gatz and the second party

C. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

Key: B (James Gatz and the second party)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter VI"? 'his Platonic conception of himself': an ideal self-creation.

A. Symbolism

B. Hyperbole

C. Point of view

D. Diction / vocabulary

Key: D (Diction / vocabulary)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter VI"? Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.

A. Characterization

B. Tone / mood

C. Setting

D. Allusion

Key: A (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how the past and time develops from Chapter V to Chapter VI. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter V, paragraph 118, the text reads "They're such beautiful shirts" — Daisy's tears over the shirts. In Chapter VI, "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) — Gatsby's real name. Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby want Daisy to say to Tom?

A. She never loved him

B. She is leaving

C. Sorry

D. Goodbye

Key: A (She never loved him)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Well, he certainly must have strained himself to get this _____ together." Word bank: debauchee, volleying, menagerie, countered

Key: menagerie

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The _____ limousine came rolling up the drive." Word bank: debauchee, dilatory, countered, volleying

    Key: dilatory

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "You can't repeat the past" (Chapter VI, paragraph 128). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Nick's warning. The evidence is "You can't repeat the past" (Chapter VI, paragraph 128). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The words "repeat" and "past" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should Nick have told us Gatsby's true history earlier?

    Sample answer: An argument about structure: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who mentored Gatsby?

    A. Nick's father
    B. Meyer Wolfshiem
    C. Tom Buchanan
    D. Dan Cody

    Key: D (Dan Cody)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is self-invention admirable or dangerous in Gatsby's case?

    Sample answer: A reasoned evaluation: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

24. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who comes with Tom to Gatsby's?

    Sample answer: Mr. Sloane and a woman.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Daisy feel at the party?

    A. Thrilled
    B. Angry at Nick
    C. Uneasy and unimpressed
    D. Bored but happy

    Key: C (Uneasy and unimpressed)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

    A. The past and time
    B. Class and money
    C. The American Dream
    D. Illusion and reality

    Key: A (The past and time)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “It was dark here in front; only the bright door sent ten square feet of light volleying out into the soft black morning.”, what does “volleying” most nearly mean?

    A. pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots

    B. to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering

    C. replied in opposition

    D. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

    Key: A (pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots)

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Self-invention. The evidence is “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “For several weeks I didn’t see him or hear his voice on the phone—mostly I was in New York, trotting around with Jordan and trying to ingratiate myself with her senile aunt—but finally I went over to his house one…”, what does “ingratiate” most nearly mean?

    A. replied in opposition

    B. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

    C. to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering

    D. pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots

    Key: C (to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Claim: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).

    Sample answer: Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!". The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) — Gatsby's real name. This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Chapter VI?

    A. “Just why these inventions were a source of satisfaction to James Gatz of North Dakota, isn’t easy to say.”

    B. “It was a random shot, and yet the reporter’s instinct was right.”

    C. “About this time an ambitious young reporter from New York arrived one morning at Gatsby’s door and asked him if he had anything to say.”

    D. “Gatsby’s notoriety, spread about by the hundreds who had accepted his hospitality and so become authorities upon his past, had increased…”

Key: C ("About this time an ambitious young reporter from New York arrived one morning at Gatsby's door and asked him if he had anything to say.")

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 82 shapes its tone: "But what had amused me then turned septic on the air now." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "amused" and "turned" (Chapter VI, paragraph 82) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: "They were a party of three on horseback—Tom and a man named Sloane and a pretty woman in a brown riding-habit, who had been there previously." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "previously" and "horseback" (Chapter VI, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 47 shapes its tone: "He wanted to go and he didn't see that Mr. Sloane had determined he shouldn't." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "determined" and "shouldn" (Chapter VI, paragraph 47) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 62 to the story's treatment of the past and time: "If you want to kiss me any time during the evening, Nick, just let me know and I'll be glad to arrange it for you." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VI, paragraph 62) develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Its words "evening" and "arrange" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Tom and Daisy stared, with that peculiarly unreal feeling that accompanies the recognition of a hitherto ghostly…" (Chapter VI, paragraph 68), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: "Each night he added to the pattern of his fancies until drowsiness closed down upon some vivid scene with an oblivious embrace." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VI, paragraph 9) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Its words "drowsiness" and "oblivious" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "An instinct toward his future glory had led him, some months before, to the small Lutheran College of St. Olaf's in…" (Chapter VI, paragraph 10), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of the past and time: "I suppose he smiled at Cody—he had probably discovered that people liked him when he smiled." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VI, paragraph 12) develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Its words "discovered" and "probably" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "A few days later he took him to Duluth and bought him a blue coat, six pairs of white duck trousers, and a yachting cap." (Chapter VI, paragraph 12),

so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VI, paragraph 59 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “Tom and I shook hands, the rest of us exchanged a cool nod, and they trotted quickly down the drive, disappearing under the August foliage just as Gatsby, with hat and light overcoat in hand, came out the front door.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VI, paragraph 59) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Its words “disappearing” and “exchanged” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Perhaps his presence gave the evening its peculiar quality of oppressiveness—it stands out in my memory from Gatsby's…” (Chapter VI, paragraph 60), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The words “legally” and “really” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 19, 1, 5, 8, 6, 13, 10, 11, 12, 20, 14, 15, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 19, 18, 5, 22, 9, 4, 13, 10, 12, 11, 14, 15, 20, 23, 16	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 24, 25, 1, 22, 7, 13, 12, 10, 11, 14, 20, 26, 15, 23, 21	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 18, 24, 4, 9, 13, 12, 10, 11, 14, 20, 15, 26, 16, 21, 23	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 27, 25, 9, 2, 11, 13, 10, 12, 26, 20, 14, 15, 23, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Freshman	18, 24, 1, 22, 6, 12, 13, 11, 10, 14, 15, 26, 20, 16, 23, 21	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	18, 6, 2, 13, 10, 11, 28, 29, 12, 14, 15, 20, 26, 16, 21, 23	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Junior	30, 22, 5, 6, 10, 13, 12, 11, 15, 14, 26, 31, 20, 21, 16, 23	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 3
College Senior	19, 6, 1, 32, 12, 33, 34, 26, 35, 36, 16, 37, 23, 21, 38, 39	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	2, 6, 18, 1, 12, 13, 34, 35, 21, 38, 16, 39, 40, 36, 37, 23	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VI,” how does Fitzgerald show James Gatz and the second party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VI, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of James Gatz and the second party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of James Gatz and the second party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about James Gatz and the second party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of James Gatz and the second party. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of James Gatz and the second party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of James Gatz and the second party follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of James Gatz and the second party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about James Gatz and the second party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of James Gatz and the second party. Position your reading

within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *I remember the portrait of him up in Gatsby's bedroom, a grey, florid man with a hard, empty face—the pioneer debauchee, who during one phase of American life brought back to the Eastern seaboard the savage violence of the frontier brothel and saloon.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "debauchee" most nearly mean?

   A. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures
   B. lacking ambition or drive to get ahead
   C. hard to catch hold of or remember
   D. slow; causing delay

2. *It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand. This was his day off and with laudable initiative he had hurried out "to see."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VI"?

   A. The Plaza and the death car
   B. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party
   C. James Gatz and the second party
   D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

SAT key: 1. A (a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures); 2. C (James Gatz and the second party)

Lesson 8: Chapter VII

Focus: the Plaza and the death car

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Chapter VII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (racist speech (a character), traffic death, graphic injury, adultery, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): In the Plaza scene Tom warns of 'intermarriage between black and white'; later Myrtle is struck and killed by a car, with one graphic sentence about her injuries. Frame Tom's speech as the bigotry of a threatened man; present the death briefly and move to responsibility. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…’m glad to see you, sir … Nick …” “Make us a cold drink,” cried Daisy. As he left the room agai…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: A character makes a racist speech, and a woman is killed by a car (one sentence describes her injuries).
Suggested language: “What does Tom's speech reveal about why he fights Gatsby?”

Teacher only · spoilers

On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the road, killing her. Gatsby waits outside the Buchanans' house; Nick sees Tom and Daisy conspiring.

Background: The Plaza Hotel on Fifth Avenue was a landmark of luxury. Tom's charge that Gatsby and Wolfshiem 'bought up a lot of side-street drug-stores' reflects a real Prohibition practice: pharmacies could sell alcohol on prescription and served as fronts for bootlegging. Cars were new and lightly regulated; traffic deaths rose sharply in the 1920s.

Significance: The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does heat raise tension? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: A character makes a racist speech, and a woman is killed by a car (one sentence describes her injuries).
Prompt: How does heat raise tension?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: old money defeats new money.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: commutation — for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket); dampened — became slightly wet; genially — in a friendly, cheerful way; harrowing — deeply distressing to go through; formidable — impressively powerful and a little frightening. “commutation”: Origin: French commutation; earlier Latin commūtātiōnem. “formidable”: From Latin formidabilis "causing fear," from formido "fear, terror." (Not from forma "shape.")
Words: commutation: for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket) · dampened: became slightly wet · genially: in a friendly, cheerful way · harrowing: deeply distressing to go through · formidable: impressively powerful and a little frightening

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Plaza Hotel on Fifth Avenue was a landmark of luxury. Tom's charge that Gatsby and Wolfshiem 'bought up a lot of side-street drug-stores' reflects a real Prohibition practice: pharmacies could sell alcohol on prescription and served as fronts for bootlegging. Cars were new and lightly regulated; traffic deaths rose sharply in the 1920s. The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer. Setting: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation. Characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Symbolism: Daisy's voice "full of money." Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “I went with them out to the veranda. On the green Sound, stagnant in the heat, one small sail crawled slowly toward” (Chapter VII, paragraph 68).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “I did love him once—but I loved you too” slowly and put it in my own words: Daisy tells Gatsby she loved Tom once, but she loved him too. Next, craft. I notice the dash and the "but," which split her love in two. The strongest word is “once”: it admits her past with Tom, which Gatsby needs to erase. Then, effect. What does Daisy's admission do to Gatsby's dream? My answer: Gatsby wanted her to say she never loved Tom; her honest answer destroys his dream of erasing the past.

> *I did love him once—but I loved you too* (Chapter VII, paragraph 263)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “I did love him once—but I loved you too” slowly and put it in my own words: Daisy tells Gatsby she loved Tom once, but she loved him too. Next, craft. I notice the dash and the "but," which split her love in two. The strongest word is “once”: it admits her past with Tom, which Gatsby needs to erase. Then, effect. What does Daisy's admission do to Gatsby's dream? My answer: Gatsby wanted her to say she never loved Tom; her honest answer destroys his dream of erasing the past.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Daisy's charm is the sound of wealth and security. Expected link: class and money. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: Old money defeats new money. (Gatsby's insight about Daisy.)

> *Her voice is full of money (Chapter VII, paragraph 104)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Daisy's charm is the sound of wealth and security. Expected link: class and money.
Ask: How does this line connect to class and money?
Expected answer: Old money defeats new money. (Gatsby's insight about Daisy.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. When the text says "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. When the text says "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does heat raise tension? Who wins at the Plaza, and why?
Anchor question: How does heat raise tension?
Facilitation: Who wins at the Plaza, and why?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. ("Her voice is full of money", Chapter VII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. ("Her voice is full of money", Chapter VII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the Plaza and the death car. Key takeaway: old money defeats new money.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.
- **Characterization:** Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom.
- **Symbolism:** Daisy's voice "full of money."

Themes and how they develop

- **class and money:** old money defeats new money.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "I went with them out to the veranda. On the green Sound, stagnant in the heat, one small sail crawled slowly toward" (Chapter VII, paragraph 68).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "in like a card house at the disapproval in her eyes" (Chapter VII, paragraph 15).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) Gatsby's insight about Daisy.
- "I did love him once—but I loved you too" (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) Daisy's answer.
- "Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness" (Chapter VII, paragraph 307) Nick's birthday reflection.

- "The "death car" (Chapter VII, paragraph 315) The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream.
Evidence: "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104)
Reasoning: Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
commutation (adjective)	for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket)	*My commutation ticket came back to me with a dark stain from his hand.*	"commutation": Origin: French commutation; earlier Latin commūtātiōnem. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/commutation#Etymology)
dampened (verb)	became slightly wet	*The straw seats of the car hovered on the edge of combustion; the woman next to me perspired delicately for a while into her white shirtwaist, and then, as her newspaper dampened under her fingers, lapsed despairingly into deep heat with a desolate cry.*	
genially (adverb)	in a friendly, cheerful way	*"I read somewhere that the sun's getting hotter every year," said Tom genially.*	
harrowing (adjective)	deeply distressing to go through	*And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.*	
formidable (adjective)	impressively powerful and a little frightening	*As we passed over the dark bridge her wan face fell lazily against my coat's shoulder and the formidable stroke of thirty died away with the reassuring pressure of her hand.*	"formidable": From Latin formidabilis "causing fear," from formido "fear, terror." (Not from forma "shape.") (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/formidable)
caravansary (noun)	an inn for travelling groups; here, Gatsby's	*So the whole caravansary had fallen in like a card house at the disapproval in her eyes.*	

	crowded house of guests		
alongshore (adverb)	along the shore	*Our eyes lifted over the rose-beds and the hot lawn and the weedy refuse of the dog-days alongshore.*	"alongshore": Origin: an English formation from along + shore. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/alongshore#Etymology)
luminosity (noun)	the quality of giving off light; brightness	*I must have felt pretty weird by that time, because I could think of nothing except the luminosity of his pink suit under the moon.*	
vicariously (adverb)	by imagining someone else's experience rather than having it oneself	*At this point Jordan and I tried to go, but Tom and Gatsby insisted with competitive firmness that we remain—as though neither of them had anything to conceal and it would be a privilege to partake vicariously of their emotions.*	
boisterously (adverb)	in a loud, rowdy, high-spirited way	*"Plenty of gas," said Tom boisterously.*	

Discussion questions

1. How does heat raise tension?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with class and money?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Myrtle run into the road? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She thinks Tom is in the car.
2. What does Gatsby plan to say? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he was driving.
3. Where is the confrontation? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Plaza Hotel

4. Whose car does Tom drive to the city? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby's
5. Who is driving when Myrtle is killed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Daisy
6. What does Tom reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby's illegal business
7. What birthday is it for Nick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thirtieth
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the road, killing her. Gatsby waits outside the Buchanans' house; Nick sees Tom and Daisy conspiring.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter VII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Daisy fail Gatsby at the Plaza? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She cannot deny the past with Tom.
2. What does Nick see through the window? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Tom and Daisy in intimacy.
3. What does "Chapter VII" suggest about the Plaza and the death car? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer.
4. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
5. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the Plaza and the death car? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "He was calling up at Daisy's request—would I come to lunch at her house tomorrow?", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their

connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the…
8. How does “Chapter VII” build on “Chapter VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “How does heat raise tension?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who is responsible for Myrtle's death? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Is Daisy careless, trapped or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from…” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look

for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the Plaza and the death car? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the past and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On setting: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter VII” treats the Plaza and the death car with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter VIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby plan to say?
   Sample answer: That he was driving.
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I must have felt pretty weird by that time, because I could think of nothing except the _____ of his pink suit under the moon.” Word bank: luminosity, dampened, genially, commutation
   Key: luminosity
3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Myrtle run into the road?
   Sample answer: She thinks Tom is in the car.
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The straw seats of the car hovered on the edge of combustion; the woman next to me perspired delicately for a while into her white shirtwaist, and then, as her newspaper dampened under her fingers, lapsed despairingly…”, what does “dampened” most nearly mean?
   A. lost for good; impossible to get back
   B. became slightly wet
   C. in a pattern of bright, many-coloured diamonds or patches
   D. still alive and strongly felt
   Key: B (became slightly wet)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “My commutation ticket came back to me with a dark stain from his hand.”, what does “commutation” most nearly mean?

   A. ways of dodging a question without really answering

   B. for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket)

   C. a blessing given with a raised hand

   D. without caring whether it was honest or right

   Key: B (for regular travel (a commutation ticket is a season ticket))

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Tom reveal?

   A. Daisy's letters

   B. His affair

   C. Gatsby's illegal business

   D. His debts

   Key: C (Gatsby's illegal business)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VII, paragraph 307: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of _____”

   Key: loneliness

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So the whole _____ had fallen in like a card house at the disapproval in her eyes.” Word bank: commutation, dampened, genially, caravansary

   Key: caravansary

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Our eyes lifted over the rose-beds and the hot lawn and the weedy refuse of the dog-days _____.” Word bank: alongshore, genially, dampened, commutation

   Key: alongshore

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Daisy fail Gatsby at the Plaza?

    Sample answer: She cannot deny the past with Tom. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) — Gatsby's insight about Daisy. This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Nick see through the window?

    Sample answer: Tom and Daisy in intimacy: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Daisy's answer. The evidence is “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VII”?

    A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

    B. The Plaza and the death car

    C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

    D. The reunion

    Key: B (The Plaza and the death car)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Old money defeats new money.

    A. Illusion and reality

    B. The American Dream

    C. Class and money

    D. The past and time

    Key: C (Class and money)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter VII"? The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.

    A. Plot

    B. Setting

    C. Point of view

    D. Alliteration

    Key: B (Setting)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words "voice" and "money" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What birthday is it for Nick?

    A. Twenty-fifth

    B. Fortieth

    C. Twenty-first

    D. Thirtieth

    Key: D (Thirtieth)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "As we passed over the dark bridge her wan face fell lazily against my coat's shoulder and the _____ stroke of thirty died away with the reassuring pressure of her hand." Word bank: dampened, genially, formidable, commutation
    Key: formidable

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.", what does "harrowing" most nearly mean?

    A. not needed; unimportant

    B. someone who finds or shows the way in new country

    C. deeply distressing to go through

    D. hints, often sly or sexual, made without saying something directly

    Key: C (deeply distressing to go through)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is the confrontation?

    A. Nick's office

B. The valley of ashes

C. The Plaza Hotel

D. Gatsby's house

Key: C (The Plaza Hotel)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The ‘death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315)

A. The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

B. First image of the green light.

C. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

D. The reason for everything.

Key: A (The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VII”? Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom.

A. Imagery

B. Characterization

C. Theme

D. Simile

Key: B (Characterization)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how class and money develops from Chapter II to Chapter VII. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter II, paragraph 1, the text reads “This is a valley of ashes”, which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. In Chapter VII, “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) — Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Old money defeats new money.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “‘I read somewhere that the sun’s getting hotter every year,’ said Tom genially.”, what does “genially” most nearly mean?

A. moves suddenly and unsteadily

B. moved with quick, showy, impatient movements

C. making a loud, harsh, wailing noise

D. in a friendly, cheerful way

Key: D (in a friendly, cheerful way)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is driving when Myrtle is killed?

A. Tom

B. Nick

C. Gatsby

D. Daisy

Key: D (Daisy)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104).

Sample answer: Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too"

destroys his demand for total possession of the past. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) — Gatsby's insight about Daisy. This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Who is responsible for Myrtle's death?
    Sample answer: A reasoned judgment: the newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. The evidence is “The ‘death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Daisy careless, trapped or both?
    Sample answer: An evaluation: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Nick's birthday reflection. The evidence is “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words “loneliness” and “promise” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whose car does Tom drive to the city?

    A. Wilson's
    B. Nick's
    C. Gatsby's
    D. Jordan's

    Key: C (Gatsby's)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Daisy's answer. The evidence is “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words “loved” and “love” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104)

    A. The dream shrinks when reached.
    B. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.
    C. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.
    D. Wilson on the eyes.

    Key: B (Gatsby's insight about Daisy.)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VII, paragraph 1: “It was when _____ about Gatsby was at its highest that the lights in his house failed to go on one Saturday night—and, as obscurely as it had begun, his career as Trimalchio was over.” Word bank: curiosity, fascinated, impatiently, furnish

    Key: curiosity

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 93 shapes its tone: “They went upstairs to get ready while we three men stood there shuffling the hot pebbles with our feet.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “shuffling” and “upstairs” (Chapter VII, paragraph 93) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: old money defeats new money. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 298 shapes its tone: “They were gone, without a word, snapped out, made accidental, isolated, like ghosts, even from our pity.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “accidental” and “isolated” (Chapter VII, paragraph 298) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: old money defeats new money. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 323 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “He reached up on tiptoes and peered over a circle of heads into the garage, which was lit only by a yellow light in a swinging metal basket overhead.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VII, paragraph 323) develops carelessness and morality: old money defeats new money. Its words “swinging” and “overhead” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “At first I couldn’t find the source of the high, groaning words that echoed clamorously through the bare garage—then I…” (Chapter VII, paragraph 325), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 173 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “The room was large and stifling, and, though it was already four o’clock, opening the windows admitted only a gust of hot shrubbery from the Park.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VII, paragraph 173) develops the past and time: old money defeats new money. Its words “shrubbery” and “admitted” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “A man named Biloxi. ‘Blocks’ Biloxi, and he made boxes—that’s a fact—and he was from Biloxi, Tennessee.” (Chapter VII, paragraph 192), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 354 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “Only the negro and I were near enough to hear what he said, but the policeman caught something in the tone and looked over with truculent eyes.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VII, paragraph 354) develops the past and time: old money defeats new money. Its words “something” and “policeman” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Self-consciously, with his authoritative arms breaking the way, we pushed through the still gathering crowd, passing a…” (Chapter VII, paragraph 365), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 145 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “But I need money pretty bad, and I was wondering what you were going to do with your old car.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VII, paragraph 145) develops carelessness and morality: old money defeats new money. Its words “wondering” and “pretty” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “That locality was always vaguely disquieting, even in the broad glare of afternoon, and now I turned my head as though…” (Chapter VII, paragraph 161), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.
41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VII, paragraph 260 shapes its tone: “From the ballroom beneath, muffled and suffocating chords were drifting up on hot waves of air.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “suffocating” and “drifting” (Chapter VII, paragraph 260) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: old money defeats new money. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 5, 2, 18, 19, 20, 8, 12, 11, 21, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 8, 24, 25, 1, 6, 10, 21, 11, 13, 12, 26, 22, 14, 27, 23	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 6, 3, 7, 4, 5, 13, 12, 21, 10, 11, 22, 14, 15, 23, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 8, 24, 5, 12, 10, 11, 21, 13, 22, 15, 29, 26, 27, 28, 23	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	18, 8, 30, 13, 21, 11, 10, 12, 26, 29, 15, 14, 22, 23, 28, 27	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 3
College Freshman	18, 24, 9, 10, 11, 31, 13, 21, 12, 22, 14, 15, 29, 23, 27, 28	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	17, 2, 7, 3, 13, 11, 21, 10, 22, 14, 15, 23, 32, 27, 16, 28	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Junior	9, 18, 25, 17, 12, 11, 10, 13, 33, 21, 14, 15, 22, 27, 28, 23	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Senior	34, 18, 20, 30, 21, 29, 35, 14, 36, 27, 37, 28, 38, 39, 40, 23	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	18, 8, 21, 14, 41, 36, 22, 15, 35, 40, 37, 28, 38, 23, 39, 27	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VII,” how does Fitzgerald show the Plaza and the death car? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VII, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the Plaza and the death car? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Plaza and the death car. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the Plaza and the death car. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses setting in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the Plaza and the death car. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the Plaza and the death car responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the Plaza and the death car follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the Plaza and the death car. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the Plaza and the death car in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the Plaza and the death car. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *"I read somewhere that the sun's getting hotter every year," said Tom genially.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "genially" most nearly mean?

   A. in a friendly, cheerful way

   B. in a loud, rowdy, high-spirited way

   C. by imagining someone else's experience rather than having it oneself

   D. the quality of giving off light; brightness

2. *He was calling up at Daisy's request—would I come to lunch at her house tomorrow? Miss Baker would be there. Half an hour later Daisy herself telephoned and seemed relieved to find that I was coming. Something was up. And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VII"?

   A. Gatsby's death

   B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   C. The Plaza and the death car

   D. Gatsby's party

SAT key: 1. A (in a friendly, cheerful way); 2. C (The Plaza and the death car)

Lesson 9: Chapter VIII

Focus: Gatsby's death

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Chapter VIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Only Gatsby himself genuinely lives and breathes. The rest are mere marionettes — often astonishingly lifelike, but nevertheless not quite alive.” (H. L. Mencken, critic and journalist, *Review of The Great Gatsby, Chicago Sunday Tribune (3 May 1925), reprinted as "Time Machine" (10 Oct 2014), section "Profiting by Criticism"*; public domain). Rebuttal: choose Nick, Daisy, or Wilson and argue that Mencken is wrong about them, using Chapter VIII. *Objective:* Evaluate characterization as the novel reaches Gatsby's death. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (murder, suicide, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Wilson shoots Gatsby and then himself. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss grief, misinformation and Tom's role, not methods. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…Catherine. She must have broken her rule against drinking that night, for when she arrived she wa…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This chapter includes a killing and a suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “How did a lie lead to these deaths?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.

Background: Fitzgerald alternates Nick's account with the testimony of Michaelis, the Greek coffee-shop owner beside Wilson's garage, as at an inquest. Wilson's belief that the billboard eyes are God's draws on the period's loss of traditional faith that writers such as T. S. Eliot (The Waste Land, 1922) described.

Significance: Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When should a friend speak up? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the American Dream because.... Content note before we start: This chapter includes a killing and a suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: When should a friend speak up?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the American Dream because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby dies still believing.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: amorphous — without a clear shape; scurried — moved quickly with short, hurried movements; ravenously — with great, greedy hunger; fortuitously — by chance; without plan; corroborate — to confirm that something is true. "ravenously": Origin of "ravenous": Old French ravineus.
Words: amorphous: without a clear shape · scurried: moved quickly with short, hurried movements · ravenously: with great, greedy hunger · fortuitously: by chance; without plan · corroborate: to confirm that something is true

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fitzgerald alternates Nick's account with the testimony of Michaelis, the Greek coffee-shop owner beside Wilson's garage, as at an inquest. Wilson's belief that the billboard eyes are God's draws on the period's loss of traditional faith that writers such as T. S. Eliot (The Waste Land, 1922) described. Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby. Characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Symbolism: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Structure: Gatsby is shot in his pool. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "stood there for a minute and then turned out the light" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 3).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "They're a rotten crowd" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick shouts to Gatsby that the others are rotten and he is worth more than all of them. Next, craft. I notice it is a quick spoken judgment, unusual for reserved Nick. The strongest word is "rotten": it means corrupt and decaying, a moral judgment on the rich. Then, effect. Why does Nick call Tom and Daisy's crowd "rotten"? My answer: Nick calls Tom and Daisy's crowd "rotten" because they are careless and selfish; despite Gatsby's lies, Nick has taken a side, judging Gatsby's hope more honest than the rich.

> *They're a rotten crowd* *(Chapter VIII, paragraph 45)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "They're a rotten crowd" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick shouts to Gatsby that the others are rotten and he is worth more than all of them. Next, craft. I notice it is a quick spoken judgment, unusual for reserved Nick. The strongest word is "rotten": it means corrupt and decaying, a moral judgment on the rich. Then, effect. Why does Nick call Tom and Daisy's crowd "rotten"? My answer: Nick calls Tom and Daisy's crowd "rotten" because they are careless and selfish; despite Gatsby's lies, Nick has taken a side, judging Gatsby's hope more honest than the rich.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nick's praise. Look at the craft: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream? Expected: Gatsby dies still believing. (Nick's praise.)

> *You're worth the whole damn bunch put together* *(Chapter VIII, paragraph 45)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Nick's praise. Look at the craft: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.
Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream?
Expected answer: Gatsby dies still believing. (Nick's praise.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. When the text says "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. When the text says "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When should a friend speak up? Is Nick right about Gatsby?
Anchor question: When should a friend speak up?
Facilitation: Is Nick right about Gatsby?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. ("God sees everything", Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. ("God sees everything", Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Gatsby's death. Key takeaway: Gatsby dies still believing.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.
- **Symbolism:** Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.
- **Structure:** Gatsby is shot in his pool.

Themes and how they develop

- **the American Dream:** Gatsby dies still believing.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “stood there for a minute and then turned out the light” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 3).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “men had already loved Daisy—it increased her value in his eyes. He felt their presence all about the house, pervading the air” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 10).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Nick's verdict.
- “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Nick's praise.
- “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) Wilson on the eyes.
- “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.
- “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110) Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich.
Evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104)
Reasoning: He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
amorphous (adjective)	without a clear shape	*A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams*	

		like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.	
scurried (verb)	moved quickly with short, hurried movements	*Wilson's glazed eyes turned out to the ash-heaps, where small grey clouds took on fantastic shapes and scurried here and there in the faint dawn wind.*	
ravenously (adverb)	with great, greedy hunger	*He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he had no real right to touch her hand.*	"ravenously": Origin of "ravenous": Old French ravineus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ravenous#Etymology)
fortuitously (adverb)	by chance; without plan	*A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.*	
corroborate (verb)	to confirm that something is true	*He looked at me anxiously, as if he hoped I'd corroborate this.*	
redolent (adjective)	strongly suggestive of; smelling of	*For Daisy was young and her artificial world was redolent of orchids and pleasant, cheerful snobbery and orchestras which set the rhythm of the year, summing up the sadness and suggestiveness of life in new tunes.*	
vestibule (noun)	the entrance platform at the end of a railway car	*He went out to the open vestibule and sat down on a folding-chair, and the station slid away and the backs of unfamiliar buildings moved by.*	
unscrupulously (adverb)	without caring whether it was honest or right	*He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he had no real right to touch her hand.*	
vibrant (adjective)	still alive and strongly felt	*He felt their presence all about the house, pervading the air with the shades and echoes of still vibrant emotions.*	
practicality (noun)	usefulness and good sense in real life	*She wanted her life shaped now, immediately—and the decision must be made by some force—of love, of money, of unquestionable practicality—that was close at hand.*	

Discussion questions

1. When should a friend speak up?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the past and time?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What did Gatsby wait for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Daisy's call.
2. What does Wilson do after shooting Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He shoots himself.
3. Where is Gatsby shot? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In his pool
4. Who shoots him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: George Wilson
5. What does Nick tell Gatsby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They're a rotten crowd
6. What does Wilson believe watches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: God through Eckleburg's eyes
7. Who comforts Wilson? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Michaelis
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VIII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VIII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter VIII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Nick's praise meaningful? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He disapproved of Gatsby from beginning to end.
2. What does the pool suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The end of summer and dream.
3. What does "Chapter VIII" suggest about Gatsby's death? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never

comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby.

4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's death? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. On symbolism: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “But he knew that he was in Daisy’s house by a colossal accident.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.
8. How does “Chapter VIII” build on “Chapter VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. On structure: Gatsby is shot in his pool. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “When should a friend speak up?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Did Gatsby die for a dream or a lie? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned argument.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Who led Wilson to Gatsby? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Tom.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110): Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's death? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Connect this chapter to illusion and reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110): Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter VIII” treats Gatsby's death with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter IX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He looked at me anxiously, as if he hoped I’d _____ this.” Word bank: scurried, amorphous, corroborate, ravenously
   Key: corroborate
2. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Wilson do after shooting Gatsby?
   Sample answer: He shoots himself.
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He took what he could get, ravenously and _____—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he

had no real right to touch her hand." Word bank: unscrupulously, ravenously, amorphous, scurried

Key: unscrupulously

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 45: "You're worth the whole damn bunch put _____"

   Key: together

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Nick tell Gatsby?

   A. They're a rotten crowd
   B. Run away
   C. Confess
   D. Forget her

   Key: A (They're a rotten crowd)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Wilson's glazed eyes turned out to the ash-heaps, where small grey clouds took on fantastic shapes and scurried here and there in the faint dawn wind.", what does "scurried" most nearly mean?

   A. built up in rising layers or rows
   B. moved quickly with short, hurried movements
   C. a disappointing letdown after something exciting
   D. stay longer than (is wanted)

   Key: B (moved quickly with short, hurried movements)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He went out to the open _____ and sat down on a folding-chair, and the station slid away and the backs of unfamiliar buildings moved by." Word bank: scurried, vestibule, ravenously, amorphous

   Key: vestibule

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "For Daisy was young and her artificial world was _____ of orchids and pleasant, cheerful snobbery and orchestras which set the rhythm of the year, summing up the sadness and suggestiveness of life in new tunes." Word bank: redolent, scurried, ravenously, amorphous

   Key: redolent

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comforts Wilson?

   A. Michaelis
   B. Catherine
   C. Tom
   D. Nick

   Key: A (Michaelis)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who shoots him?

    A. Wolfshiem
    B. George Wilson
    C. Tom
    D. Daisy

    Key: B (George Wilson)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the pool suggest?
    Sample answer: The end of summer and dream. The evidence is “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) — Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is Nick's praise meaningful?
    Sample answer: He disapproved of Gatsby from beginning to end. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) — Nick's praise. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VIII”? Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.
    A. Characterization
    B. Irony
    C. Allusion
    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Characterization)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Wilson on the eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “everything” and “sees” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how the American Dream develops from Chapter IV to Chapter VIII. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter IV, paragraph 24, the text reads “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” — Gatsby's invented past. In Chapter VIII, “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) — Nick's verdict. Gatsby dies still believing.
17. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Gatsby wait for?
    Sample answer: Daisy's call.
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Gatsby shot?
    A. In the library
    B. In his car
    C. At the Plaza
    D. In his pool

    Key: D (In his pool)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.”, what does “amorphous” most nearly mean?
    A. built up in rising layers or rows
    B. stretching out longer
    C. without a clear shape

D. an inflated sense of one's own importance

Key: C (without a clear shape)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Wilson believe watches?

A. The police

B. Gatsby

C. God through Eckleburg's eyes

D. Tom

Key: C (God through Eckleburg's eyes)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VIII”?

A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

C. The reunion

D. Gatsby's death

Key: D (Gatsby's death)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Gatsby dies still believing.

A. Class and money

B. The American Dream

C. The past and time

D. Illusion and reality

Key: B (The American Dream)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Who led Wilson to Gatsby?

Sample answer: Tom: Wilson on the eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Did Gatsby die for a dream or a lie?

Sample answer: A reasoned argument: Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. The evidence is “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter VIII, paragraph 21? “It was dawn now on Long Island and we went about opening the rest of the windows _____, filling the house with grey-turning, gold-turning light.”

A. married

B. breaking

C. downstairs

D. decent

Key: C (downstairs)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter VIII, paragraph 49? “Just before noon the phone woke me, and I started up with sweat _____ out on my forehead.”

    A. downstairs

    B. acknowledged

    C. mysterious

    D. breaking

    Key: D (breaking)

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “Crossing his lawn, I saw that his front door was still open and he was leaning against a table in the hall, heavy with dejection or sleep.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “dejection” and “against” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 49 reveal about the character or situation? “Usually her voice came over the wire as something fresh and cool, as if a divot from a green golf-links had come sailing in at the office window, but this morning it seemed harsh and dry.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 49) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “something” and “morning” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VIII”? Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Personification

    C. Symbolism

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Symbolism)

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 64 shapes its tone: “When they convinced her of this, she immediately fainted, as if that was the intolerable part of the affair.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “immediately” and “intolerable” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 64) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby dies still believing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 16 shapes its tone: “It was a cold fall day, with fire in the room and her cheeks flushed.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “flushed” and “cheeks” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 16) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Gatsby dies still believing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104).
    Sample answer: He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) — Wilson on the eyes. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) supports it: He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes. But “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) complicates it: Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance, and it pulls the other way. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 107 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “Thus far there was no difficulty in accounting for his time—there were boys who had seen a man ‘acting sort of crazy,’ and motorists at whom he stared oddly from the side of the road.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 107) develops the past and time: Gatsby dies still believing. Its words “accounting” and “difficulty” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “At two o’clock Gatsby put on his bathing-suit and left word with the butler that if anyone phoned word was to be…” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 108), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 15: “What was the use of doing great things if I could have a better time _____ her what I was going to do?” Word bank: telling, downstairs, breakfast, worried
    Key: telling

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 12 shapes its tone: “As a matter of fact, he had no such facilities—he had no comfortable family standing behind him, and he was liable at the whim of an impersonal government to be blown anywhere about the world.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “comfortable” and “impersonal” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Gatsby dies still believing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 76 shapes its tone: “The effort of answering broke the rhythm of his rocking—for a moment he was silent.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “answering” and “rocking” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 76) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Gatsby dies still believing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 1: “I couldn’t sleep all night; a foghorn was groaning _____ on the Sound, and I tossed half-sick between grotesque reality and savage, frightening dreams.” Word bank: breakfast, afternoon, incessantly, worried
    Key: incessantly

39. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Nick's praise. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)

    A. The dream shrinks when reached.

    B. The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

    C. The reason for everything.

    D. Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.

    Key: D (Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.)

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 31 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “The gardener, the last one of Gatsby’s former servants, came to the foot of the steps.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 31) develops the past and time: Gatsby dies still believing. Its words “servants” and “gardener” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Just before I reached the hedge I remembered something and turned around.” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 44), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 100 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “This was a forlorn hope—he was almost sure that Wilson had no friend: there was not enough of him for his wife.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 100) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby dies still believing. Its words “forlorn” and “enough” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I took her to the window’—with an effort he got up and walked to the rear window and leaned with his face pressed…” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 102), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.”, what does “fortuitously” most nearly mean?

    A. moved quickly with short, hurried movements

    B. by chance; without plan

    C. without a clear shape

    D. with great, greedy hunger

    Key: B (by chance; without plan)

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Nick's praise. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “together” and “whole” carry that meaning:

they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “rotten” and “crowd” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter VIII, paragraph 21 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “There was a slow, pleasant movement in the air, scarcely a wind, promising a cool, lovely day.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter VIII, paragraph 21) develops carelessness and morality: Gatsby dies still believing. Its words “promising” and “movement” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He came back from France when Tom and Daisy were still on their wedding trip, and made a miserable but irresistible…” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 28), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

47. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 31: “It was nine o’clock when we finished _____ and went out on the porch.” Word bank: downstairs, decent, breakfast, afternoon
    Key: breakfast

48. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104)
    A. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.
    B. Daisy's tears over the shirts.
    C. Wilson on the eyes.
    D. The dream shrinks when reached.

    Key: C (Wilson on the eyes.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 10, 2, 3, 9, 18, 1, 19, 20, 5, 12, 13, 21, 15, 22, 23	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 2, 8, 17, 4, 1, 5, 18, 12, 11, 13, 21, 22, 15, 16, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Junior	25, 10, 20, 8, 26, 1, 12, 13, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	10, 1, 18, 35, 5, 13, 12, 28, 27, 15, 29, 36, 37, 33, 23, 34	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 5, 38, 18, 10, 39, 40, 36, 30, 32, 37, 31, 24, 41, 34, 42	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 43, 10, 9, 8, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 22, 33, 23, 16, 44, 24	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	1, 6, 8, 18, 28, 27, 22, 32, 37, 29, 30, 42, 34, 45, 46, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Junior	47, 20, 1, 18, 40, 30, 37, 29, 32, 31, 42, 46, 34, 16, 41, 23	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	26, 1, 8, 48, 22, 36, 29, 37, 30, 34, 23, 45, 24, 42, 33, 41	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	1, 8, 18, 10, 14, 22, 31, 36, 44, 33, 41, 24, 34, 23, 16, 42	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VIII,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's death? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's death? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's death. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests about Gatsby's death. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's death. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's death responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's death follows or bends those

conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of Gatsby's death. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's death in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's death. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he had no real right to touch her hand.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ravenously” most nearly mean?

   A. with great, greedy hunger

   B. usefulness and good sense in real life

   C. without caring whether it was honest or right

   D. still alive and strongly felt

2. *But he knew that he was in Daisy’s house by a colossal accident. However glorious might be his future as Jay Gatsby, he was at present a penniless young man without a past, and at any moment the invisible cloak of his uniform might slip from his shoulders. So he made the most of his time. He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he had no real right to touch her hand.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VIII”?

   A. The Plaza and the death car

   B. The reunion

   C. Gatsby's death

   D. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

SAT key: 1. A (with great, greedy hunger); 2. C (Gatsby's death)

Lesson 10: Chapter IX

Focus: the funeral and the meaning of the dream

Objective: Students will analyze how structure develops in “Chapter IX” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “With sensitive insight and keen psychological observation, Fitzgerald discloses in these people a meanness of spirit, carelessness and absence of loyalties. He cannot hate them, for they are dumb in their insensate selfishness, and only to be pitied.” (Edwin Clark, reviewer, *"Scott Fitzgerald Looks Into Middle Age," The New York Times Book Review (19 April 1925), final paragraph*; public domain). Compare Clark's "only to be pitied" with Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy. Does Nick pity them? *Objective:* Determine the novel's judgment on the "careless people." *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2

Content note (antisemitic stereotyping (narration), death and grief, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Nick describes a 'lovely Jewess' with 'black hostile eyes' in Wolfshiem's office. Name the stereotype; discuss it alongside the chapter's grief and the empty funeral. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…ost bitterly at Gatsby on the courage of Gatsby’s liquor, and I should have known better than to…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: The narrator uses an antisemitic stereotype; the chapter deals with a funeral.
Suggested language: “Who comes to Gatsby's funeral, and what does that show?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.

Background: The funeral's emptiness contrasts with the crowds at the parties. Henry Gatz's pride in his son's wealth and the boyhood 'schedule' echo Benjamin Franklin's famous plan of self-improvement in his Autobiography, a founding text of the American self-made man.

Significance: Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What lasts after a dream ends? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to carelessness and morality because.... Content note before we start: The narrator uses an antisemitic stereotype; the chapter deals with a funeral.
Prompt: What lasts after a dream ends?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to carelessness and morality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: inessential — not needed; unimportant; orgiastic — wildly ecstatic and unrestrained; pasquinade — a mocking public piece of satire; bulbous — fat and rounded; recedes — moves back and further away. "orgiastic": Origin: Ancient Greek ὀργιαστικός *("exciting"). "bulbous": Origin: Latin bulbosus. "recedes": Origin of "recede": Middle French receder; earlier Latin recedere ("to withdraw").*
Words: inessential: not needed; unimportant · orgiastic: wildly ecstatic and unrestrained · pasquinade: a mocking public piece of satire · bulbous: fat and rounded · recedes: moves back and further away

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The funeral's emptiness contrasts with the crowds at the parties. Henry Gatz's pride in his son's wealth and the boyhood 'schedule' echo Benjamin Franklin's famous plan of self-improvement in his Autobiography, a founding text of the American self-made man. Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal. Characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Symbolism: the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world." Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and untrue. When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick says Tom and Daisy smashed up things and people and then retreated into their money. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "smashed" next to "creatures," which treats people like objects. The strongest word is "careless": it is a mild word for terrible harm, which shows how easily the rich ignore consequences. Then, effect. What does Nick mean by calling Tom and Daisy "careless"? My answer: By calling Tom and Daisy "careless," Nick means their money lets them smash things and people and retreat; he condemns the class that let Gatsby, Myrtle and Wilson die.

> *They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money* *(Chapter IX, paragraph 154)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" slowly and put it in my own words: Nick says Tom and Daisy smashed up things and people and then retreated into their money. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "smashed" next to "creatures," which treats people like objects. The strongest word is "careless": it is a mild word for terrible harm, which shows how easily the rich ignore consequences. Then, effect. What does Nick mean by calling Tom and Daisy "careless"? My answer: By calling Tom and Daisy "careless," Nick means their money lets them smash things and people and retreat; he condemns the class that let Gatsby, Myrtle and Wilson die.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Humans keep striving forward but are pulled back. Expected link: the past and time. Ask: How does this line connect to carelessness and morality? Expected: Tom and Daisy are careless people. (The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.)

> *So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past* *(Chapter IX, paragraph 162)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Humans keep striving forward but are pulled back. Expected link: the past and time.
Ask: How does this line connect to carelessness and morality?
Expected answer: Tom and Daisy are careless people. (The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. When the text says “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154), it shows this directly. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. When the text says “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154), it shows this directly. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What lasts after a dream ends? Is the ending hopeful or tragic?
Anchor question: What lasts after a dream ends?
Facilitation: Is the ending hopeful or tragic?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. ("They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money", Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. ("They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money", Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Key takeaway: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.
- **Structure:** Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors.
- **Symbolism:** the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world."

Themes and how they develop

- **carelessness and morality:** Tom and Daisy are careless people.

Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and untrue. When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "of character about it too —looked at the coroner with determined eyes under that corrected brow of hers, and swore that her sister" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) Nick's verdict.
- "a fresh, green breast of the new world" (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.
- "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us" (Chapter IX, paragraph 161) Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.
- "So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past" (Chapter IX, paragraph 162) The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition.
Evidence: "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154)
Reasoning: Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
inessential (adjective)	not needed; unimportant	*And as the moon rose higher the inessential houses began to melt away until gradually I became aware of the old island here that flowered once for Dutch sailors' eyes—a fresh, green breast of the new world.*	
orgiastic (adjective)	wildly ecstatic and unrestrained	*Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us.*	"orgiastic": Origin: Ancient Greek ὀργιαστικός ("exciting"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/orgiastic#Etymology)
pasquinade (noun)	a mocking public piece of satire	*When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would shortly be served up in racy pasquinade—but Catherine, who might have said anything, didn't say a word.*	
bulbous (adjective)	fat and rounded	*We were so thick like that in everything"—he held up two bulbous fingers—"always together."*	"bulbous": Origin: Latin bulbosus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bulbous#Etymology)

recedes (verb)	moves back and further away	*Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us.*	"recedes": Origin of "recede": Middle French receder; earlier Latin recedere ("to withdraw"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recede#Etymology)
lustreless (adjective)	dull, without shine	*I see it as a night scene by El Greco: a hundred houses, at once conventional and grotesque, crouching under a sullen, overhanging sky and a lustreless moon.*	
adventitious (adjective)	coming from outside by chance, not truly earned	*Someone with a positive manner, perhaps a detective, used the expression "madman" as he bent over Wilson's body that afternoon, and the adventitious authority of his voice set the key for the newspaper reports next morning.*	

Discussion questions

1. What lasts after a dream ends?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with illusion and reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who refuses to come? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wolfshiem and Klipspringer.
2. What does Nick do with Jordan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He ends things with her.
3. Who comes to the funeral? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others
4. What does Gatz show Nick? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A boyhood schedule
5. What does Tom admit? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He told Wilson where Gatsby lived
6. Where does Nick go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Back West

7. What is the final image? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Boats against the current
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IX" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IX"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter IX" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatz's schedule matter? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: It shows the boy's self-making.
2. Why does Nick move West? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Disillusionment with the East.
3. What does "Chapter IX" suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.
4. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. On symbolism: the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "After two years I remember the rest of that day, and that night and the next day, only as an endless drill of police and photographers and newspaper men in and out of Gatsby's…", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in "Chapter IX", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.
8. How does "Chapter IX" build on "Chapter VIII"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. On structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. On characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. The bell-ringer asked: “What lasts after a dream ends?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the American Dream dead at the end? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Does Nick change? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluation.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. On characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to carelessness and morality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. On structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter IX” treats the funeral and the meaning of the dream with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve illusion and reality? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year _____ before us.” Word bank: inessential, recedes, pasquinade, orgiastic

   Key: recedes

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “We were so thick like that in everything’—he held up two bulbous fingers—‘always together.”, what does “bulbous” most nearly mean?

   A. the entrance platform at the end of a railway car

   B. to spread through every part of

   C. carefully, so as not to upset anyone

   D. fat and rounded

   Key: D (fat and rounded)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Tom admit?

   A. He told Wilson where Gatsby lived

   B. Nothing

   C. He was driving

   D. He loved Myrtle more

   Key: A (He told Wilson where Gatsby lived)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "And as the moon rose higher the inessential houses began to melt away until gradually I became aware of the old island here that flowered once for Dutch sailors' eyes—a fresh, green breast of the new world.", what does "inessential" most nearly mean?

   A. hard to catch hold of or remember

   B. in a pattern of bright, many-coloured diamonds or patches

   C. a disappointing letdown after something exciting

   D. not needed; unimportant

   Key: D (not needed; unimportant)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comes to the funeral?

   A. Daisy

   B. Hundreds

   C. Tom

   D. Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others

   Key: D (Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would shortly be served up in racy pasquinade—but Catherine, who might have said anything, didn't say a…", what does "pasquinade" most nearly mean?

   A. a mocking public piece of satire

   B. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

   C. fragrant yellow flowers related to the daffodil

   D. an untidy, disordered state

   Key: A (a mocking public piece of satire)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Someone with a positive manner, perhaps a detective, used the expression 'madman' as he bent over Wilson's body that afternoon, and the _____ authority of his voice set the key for the newspaper reports next morning."

   Word bank: pasquinade, adventitious, orgiastic, inessential

   Key: adventitious

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatz show Nick?

   A. A boyhood schedule

   B. A photograph of Daisy

   C. A will

   D. A letter

   Key: A (A boyhood schedule)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Nick do with Jordan?

   Sample answer: He ends things with her.

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the final image?

    A. A green light alone

    B. Boats against the current

    C. A car

D. A funeral

Key: B (Boats against the current)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Gatz's schedule matter?
Sample answer: It shows the boy's self-making: the Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159).

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IX”?
A. Gatsby's party
B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream
C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past
D. The reunion

Key: B (The funeral and the meaning of the dream)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Nick move West?
Sample answer: Disillusionment with the East: Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. The evidence is “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161).

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Tom and Daisy are careless people.
A. The past and time
B. Carelessness and morality
C. Class and money
D. The American Dream

Key: B (Carelessness and morality)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.
A. Theme
B. Metaphor
C. Characterization
D. Tone / mood

Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the American Dream dead at the end?
Sample answer: A reasoned view: the Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 159: “a fresh, green _____ of the new world”
Key: breast

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 161: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the _____ future that year by year recedes before us”
Key: orgiastic

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who refuses to come?
    Sample answer: Wolfshiem and Klipspringer.

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I see it as a night scene by El Greco: a hundred houses, at once conventional and grotesque, crouching under a sullen, overhanging sky and a _____ moon.” Word bank: pasquinade, lustreless, inessential, orgiastic
    Key: lustreless

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors.
    A. Personification
    B. Alliteration
    C. Structure
    D. Theme

    Key: C (Structure)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words “breast” and “green” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does Nick change?
    Sample answer: An evaluation: Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. The evidence is “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how carelessness and morality develops from Chapter VIII to Chapter IX. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter VIII, paragraph 45, the text reads “They’re a rotten crowd” — Nick's verdict. In Chapter IX, “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) — Nick's verdict. Tom and Daisy are careless people.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter IX, paragraph 69? “What I _____ up about was a pair of shoes I left there.”
    A. funeral
    B. catastrophe
    C. called
    D. information

    Key: C (called)

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is "a fresh, green breast of the new world" (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Chapter IX?

    A. "Someone started to ask me questions, but I broke away and going upstairs looked hastily through the unlocked parts of his desk—he'd never…"

    B. "But she and Tom had gone away early that afternoon, and taken baggage with them."

    C. "From the moment I telephoned news of the catastrophe to West Egg village, every surmise about him, and every practical question, was…"

    D. "I went back to the drawing-room and thought for an instant that they were chance visitors, all these official people who suddenly filled it."

    Key: C ("From the moment I telephoned news of the catastrophe to West Egg village, every surmise about him, and every practical question, was…")

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 69 reveal about the character or situation? "You see, they're tennis shoes, and I'm sort of helpless without them." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Chapter IX, paragraph 69) shows the situation turning on the American Dream: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words "helpless" and "without" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 85 shapes its tone: "A young major just out of the army and covered over with medals he got in the war." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "covered" and "medals" (Chapter IX, paragraph 85) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 100 shapes its tone: "For a moment I thought he was going to suggest a 'gonnegtion,' but he only nodded and shook my hand." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "gonnegtion" and "suggest" (Chapter IX, paragraph 100) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 152 shapes its tone: "Angry, and half in love with her, and tremendously sorry, I turned away." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "tremendously" and "turned" (Chapter IX, paragraph 152) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to illusion and reality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 110 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: "He opened it at the back cover and turned it around for me to see." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IX, paragraph 110) develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Its words "opened" and "turned" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "I think he rather expected me to copy down the list for my own use." (Chapter IX, paragraph 128), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 45 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “After a little while Mr. Gatz opened the door and came out, his mouth ajar, his face flushed slightly, his eyes leaking isolated and unpunctual tears.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IX, paragraph 45) develops the past and time: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Its words “unpunctual” and “isolated” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “That night an obviously frightened person called up, and demanded to know who I was before he would give his name.” (Chapter IX, paragraph 57), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Chapter IX, paragraph 21? “Such a mad act as that man did _____ make us all think.”

    A. poolroom

    B. information

    C. visitors

    D. should

    Key: D (should)

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 3: “From the moment I telephoned news of the _____ to West Egg village, every surmise about him, and every practical question, was referred to me.” Word bank: afternoon, information, catastrophe, sightseeing

    Key: catastrophe

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

37. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 162: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back _____ into the past”

    Key: ceaselessly

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words “creatures” and “retreated” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159)

    A. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.

    B. Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

C. Wilson on the eyes.

D. The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.

Key: D (The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162)

A. The reason for everything.

B. The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

C. Wilson on the eyes.

D. Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

Key: B (The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.)

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154).

Sample answer: Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.". The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) — Nick's verdict. This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 35: “It was Gatsby’s father, a solemn old man, very _____ and dismayed, bundled up in a long cheap ulster against the warm September day.” Word bank: helpless, funeral, poolroom, solemnly

Key: helpless

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “Someone started to ask me questions, but I broke away and going upstairs looked hastily through the unlocked parts of his desk—he’d never told me definitely that his parents were dead.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “definitely” and “questions” (Chapter IX, paragraph 19) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to class and money: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of carelessness and morality: “But the connection came through as a man’s voice, very thin and far away.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IX, paragraph 26) develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Its words “connection” and “through” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I think it was on the third day that a telegram signed Henry C.” (Chapter IX, paragraph 34), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating carelessness and morality as central.

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Chapter IX, paragraph 132 to the story's treatment of the past and time: “I tried to think about Gatsby then for a moment, but he was already too far away, and I could only remember, without resentment, that Daisy hadn’t sent a message or a flower.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Chapter IX, paragraph 132) develops the past and time: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Its words “resentment” and “remember” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Those who went farther than Chicago would gather in the old dim Union Station at six o’clock of a December evening,…” (Chapter IX, paragraph 139), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the past and time as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 17, 4, 7, 18, 5, 19, 20, 8, 12, 11, 13, 21, 14, 15, 22	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 10, 8, 17, 2, 19, 7, 9, 12, 13, 11, 14, 21, 15, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	25, 1, 7, 3, 20, 26, 13, 27, 11, 28, 29, 30, 31, 21, 32, 33	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 34, 35, 5, 36, 28, 11, 12, 27, 14, 30, 31, 29, 33, 16, 22	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	37, 19, 20, 10, 6, 13, 12, 11, 14, 21, 15, 38, 24, 22, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Freshman	20, 17, 4, 3, 13, 12, 39, 40, 11, 21, 15, 14, 41, 24, 16, 23	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	20, 17, 8, 5, 36, 13, 11, 26, 40, 12, 14, 15, 21, 24, 16, 23	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 3
College Junior	20, 42, 11, 27, 40, 31, 15, 21, 29, 43, 22, 23, 16, 24, 38, 33	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	20, 7, 5, 12, 43, 31, 15, 14, 41, 23, 16, 24, 44, 33, 32, 22	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	42, 20, 27, 21, 41, 15, 30, 29, 14, 32, 24, 44, 23, 45, 16, 33	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter IX,” how does Fitzgerald show the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IX, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of

textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses structure in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the funeral and the meaning of the dream follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about the funeral and the meaning of the dream in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

SAT-style questions

1. *When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would shortly be served up in racy pasquinade—but Catherine, who might have said anything, didn't say a word.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "pasquinade" most nearly mean?

   A. a mocking public piece of satire
   B. moves back and further away
   C. dull, without shine
   D. coming from outside by chance, not truly earned

2. *After two years I remember the rest of that day, and that night and the next day, only as an endless drill of police and photographers and newspaper men in and out of Gatsby's front door. A rope stretched across the main gate and a policeman by it kept out the curious, but little boys soon discovered that they could enter through my yard, and there were always a few of them clustered open-mouthed about the pool. Someone with a positive manner, perhaps a detective, used the expression "madman" as he bent over Wilson's body that afternoon, and the adventitious authority of his voice set the key for the newspaper reports next morning.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IX"?

   A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans
   B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream
   C. The reunion
   D. Gatsby's death

SAT key: 1. A (a mocking public piece of satire); 2. B (The funeral and the meaning of the dream)

Unit test

The Great Gatsby: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Nick rent a house?

   A. Chicago

   B. West Egg

   C. East Egg

   D. Manhattan

   Key: B (West Egg)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It made me uneasy, as though the whole evening had been a trick of some sort to exact a _____ emotion from me.”
   Word bank: contributory, wedging, pathfinder, anticlimax
   Key: contributory

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 152: “a _____ green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock”
   Key: single

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 118: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a _____ little fool”
   Key: beautiful

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is Nick related to Daisy?

   A. Husband

   B. Neighbour only

   C. Brother

   D. Second cousin once removed

   Key: D (Second cousin once removed)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “I was a guide, a pathfinder, an original settler.”, what does “pathfinder” most nearly mean?

   A. a prison

   B. the quality of giving off light; brightness

   C. someone who finds or shows the way in new country

D. hard to catch hold of or remember

Key: C (someone who finds or shows the way in new country)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Daisy hope her daughter will be?

   A. A doctor

   B. Rich

   C. Famous

   D. A beautiful little fool

   Key: D (A beautiful little fool)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I was about to speak when she sat up _____ and said 'Sh!' in a warning voice." Word bank: pathfinder, anticlimax, wedging, alertly

   Key: alertly

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "By seven o'clock the orchestra has arrived, no thin five-piece affair, but a whole pitful of oboes and trombones and saxophones and viols and cornets and piccolos, and low and high drums.", what does "saxophones" most nearly mean?

   A. built up in rising layers or rows

   B. still alive and strongly felt

   C. became slightly wet

   D. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz

   Key: D (brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens as guests leave?

    A. A fight breaks out

    B. Gatsby gives a speech

    C. A car crashes into a ditch

    D. It rains

    Key: C (A car crashes into a ditch)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails _____ the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each…" Word bank: chauffeurs, lurches, permeate, hydroplane

    Key: permeate

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What makes Daisy cry?

    A. Gatsby's shirts

    B. Tom's call

    C. The piano

    D. A letter

    Key: A (Gatsby's shirts)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “When he realized what I was talking about, that there were twinkle-bells of sunshine in the room, he smiled like a weather man, like an ecstatic patron of recurrent light, and repeated the news to Daisy.”, what does “recurrent” most nearly mean?

    A. a prison

    B. manners put on to impress, not natural

    C. by imagining someone else's experience rather than having it oneself

    D. coming back again and again

    Key: D (coming back again and again)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “So I don’t know whether or not Gatsby went to Coney Island, or for how many hours he ‘glanced into rooms’ while his house blazed gaudily on.”, what does “gaudily” most nearly mean?

    A. moves suddenly and unsteadily

    B. complicated consequences and connections branching from something

    C. in a showy, too-bright way

    D. lost for good; impossible to get back

    Key: C (in a showy, too-bright way)

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “For several weeks I didn’t see him or hear his voice on the phone—mostly I was in New York, trotting around with Jordan and trying to ingratiate myself with her senile aunt—but finally I went over to his house one…”, what does “ingratiate” most nearly mean?

    A. to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering

    B. in a friendly, cheerful way

    C. an inflated sense of one's own importance

    D. loud, harsh and insistent

    Key: A (to win someone's favour on purpose, often by flattering)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “It was dark here in front; only the bright door sent ten square feet of light volleying out into the soft black morning.”, what does “volleying” most nearly mean?

    A. stretching out longer

    B. along the shore

    C. moved with quick, showy, impatient movements

    D. pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots

    Key: D (pouring out suddenly, like a burst of shots)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby want Daisy to say to Tom?

    A. She never loved him

    B. She is leaving

    C. Sorry

    D. Goodbye

    Key: A (She never loved him)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Daisy feel at the party?

    A. Thrilled

    B. Angry at Nick

C. Uneasy and unimpressed

D. Bored but happy

Key: C (Uneasy and unimpressed)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who mentored Gatsby?

    A. Nick's father

    B. Meyer Wolfshiem

    C. Tom Buchanan

    D. Dan Cody

    Key: D (Dan Cody)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The _____ limousine came rolling up the drive." Word bank: debauchee, dilatory, countered, volleying

    Key: dilatory

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Well, he certainly must have strained himself to get this _____ together." Word bank: debauchee, volleying, menagerie, countered

    Key: menagerie

22. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comes with Tom to Gatsby's?

    Sample answer: Mr. Sloane and a woman.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.", what does "amorphous" most nearly mean?

    A. built up in rising layers or rows

    B. stretching out longer

    C. without a clear shape

    D. an inflated sense of one's own importance

    Key: C (without a clear shape)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Wilson believe watches?

    A. The police

    B. Gatsby

    C. God through Eckleburg's eyes

    D. Tom

    Key: C (God through Eckleburg's eyes)

25. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Gatsby wait for?

    Sample answer: Daisy's call.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 11: "He took what he could get, ravenously and _____"

    Key: unscrupulously

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 161: "Gatsby believed in the green light, the _____ future that year by year recedes before us"

    Key: orgiastic

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I see it as a night scene by El Greco: a hundred houses, at once conventional and grotesque, crouching under a sullen, overhanging sky and a _____ moon.” Word bank: pasquinade, lustreless, inessential, orgiastic

    Key: lustreless

29. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who refuses to come?

    Sample answer: Wolfshiem and Klipspringer.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 162: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back _____ into the past”

    Key: ceaselessly

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Nick go?

    A. To East Egg

    B. To Europe

    C. Back West

    D. To Chicago

    Key: C (Back West)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 159: “a fresh, green _____ of the new world”

    Key: breast

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's charm. The evidence is “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's invented past. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

35. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one

detail.

Sample answer: Self-invention. The evidence is “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The ‘death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315)

A. The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

B. First image of the green light.

C. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

D. The reason for everything.

Key: A (The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VIII”?

A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

C. The reunion

D. Gatsby's death

Key: D (Gatsby's death)

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: First image of the green light. The evidence is “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152). This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words “minute” and “single” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter I”? Nick introduces himself as a narrator ‘inclined to reserve all judgements,’ then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.

A. Point of view

B. Symbolism

C. Plot

D. Structure

Key: A (Point of view)

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

    A. The past and time

    B. Class and money

    C. The American Dream

    D. Illusion and reality

    Key: A (The past and time)

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Nick's warning. The evidence is “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The words “repeat” and “past” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

46. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154).

    Sample answer: Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.". The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) — Nick's verdict. This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors.

    A. Personification

    B. Alliteration

    C. Structure

    D. Theme

    Key: C (Structure)

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does Daisy's 'beautiful little fool' line say about women's choices in 1922?

    Sample answer: A reasoned connection to gender and power. The evidence is “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118) — Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Should Nick have told us Gatsby's true history earlier?

    Sample answer: An argument about structure: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does Nick change?

    Sample answer: An evaluation: Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. The evidence is “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

51. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 1: “In my younger and more _____ years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since”

    Key: vulnerable

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What business has Nick come East to learn?

    A. Medicine

    B. Bonds

    C. Journalism

    D. Law

    Key: B (Bonds)

53. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Gatsby reach toward at the end of the chapter?

    A. His mansion

    B. The moon

    C. A boat

    D. A green light

    Key: D (A green light)

54. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What sport did Tom play at Yale?

    Sample answer: Football; he was a famous end.

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Her husband, among various physical accomplishments, had been one of the most powerful ends that ever played football at New Haven—a national figure in a way, one of those men who reach such an acute limited excellence…”, what does “anticlimax” most nearly mean?

    A. a disappointing letdown after something exciting

    B. juicy and tasty

    C. loose short trousers gathered just below the knee

    D. strongly suggestive of; smelling of

    Key: A (a disappointing letdown after something exciting)

56. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who among the guests has actually been invited?

    Sample answer: Very few; most just come.

57. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the weather during the reunion?

    A. Snow

    B. Heat wave

    C. Rain

    D. Fog

Key: C (Rain)

58. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What nearly falls during the awkward meeting?

    A. A vase

    B. A glass

    C. A clock

    D. A chair

    Key: C (A clock)

59. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Gatsby inherit from Cody?

    Sample answer: Nothing; the legacy was taken by Ella Kaye.

60. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "'Then you ought to leave it alone,' countered Doctor Civet.", what does "countered" most nearly mean?

    A. a thin, sheer, light fabric

    B. replied in opposition

    C. a prison

    D. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz

    Key: B (replied in opposition)

61. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It _____ after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand." Word bank: transpired, volleying, debauchee, countered

    Key: transpired

62. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about … like that ashen, fantastic figure gliding toward him through the amorphous trees.", what does "fortuitously" most nearly mean?

    A. by chance; without plan

    B. deeply distressing to go through

    C. coming from outside by chance, not truly earned

    D. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

    Key: A (by chance; without plan)

63. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "We were so thick like that in everything'—he held up two bulbous fingers—'always together.", what does "bulbous" most nearly mean?

    A. the entrance platform at the end of a railway car

    B. to spread through every part of

    C. carefully, so as not to upset anyone

    D. fat and rounded

    Key: D (fat and rounded)

64. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Nick do with Jordan?

    Sample answer: He ends things with her.

65. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 154: "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and _____ and then retreated back into

their money"

Key: creatures

66. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Tom admit?

A. He told Wilson where Gatsby lived

B. Nothing

C. He was driving

D. He loved Myrtle more

Key: A (He told Wilson where Gatsby lived)

67. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the final image?

A. A green light alone

B. Boats against the current

C. A car

D. A funeral

Key: B (Boats against the current)

68. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year _____ before us." Word bank: inessential, recedes, pasquinade, orgiastic

Key: recedes

69. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "He's the man who fixed the World's Series back in 1919" (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Wolfshiem. The evidence is "He's the man who fixed the World's Series back in 1919" (Chapter IV, paragraph 113). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

70. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VII"?

A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

B. The Plaza and the death car

C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

D. The reunion

Key: B (The Plaza and the death car)

71. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

72. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152).

Sample answer: He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.". The evidence is "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152) — First image of the green light. This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

73. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Tom's casual violence. The evidence is “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words “movement” and “short” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

74. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

    A. The American Dream

    B. Class and money

    C. Illusion and reality

    D. The past and time

    Key: C (Illusion and reality)

75. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display.

    A. Point of view

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

76. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? No real woman can match ‘the colossal vitality of his illusion.’

    A. Illusion and reality

    B. The past and time

    C. The American Dream

    D. Class and money

    Key: A (Illusion and reality)

77. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104).

    Sample answer: Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past. The evidence is “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) — Gatsby's insight about Daisy. This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

78. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104).

    Sample answer: He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) — Wilson on the eyes. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

79. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VIII”? Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Personification

    C. Symbolism

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Symbolism)

80. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is self-invention admirable or dangerous in Gatsby's case?
    Sample answer: A reasoned evaluation: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

81. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Something was making him nibble at the edge of stale ideas as if his sturdy physical _____ no longer nourished his peremptory heart.” Word bank: pathfinder, egotism, anticlimax, wedging
    Key: egotism

82. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jordan Baker do?
    Sample answer: She is a golf champion.

83. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Two shining arrogant eyes had established dominance over his face and gave him the appearance of always leaning _____ forward.” Word bank: pathfinder, wedging, aggressively, anticlimax
    Key: aggressively

84. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Before I could reply that he was my neighbour dinner was announced; wedging his tense arm imperatively under mine, Tom Buchanan compelled me from the room as though he were moving a checker to another square.”, what does “wedging” most nearly mean?

    A. people paid to drive a private car

    B. designs made of a person's initials

    C. forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place

    D. without care for others' feelings; awkwardly

    Key: C (forcing (his arm) firmly into a tight place)

85. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 6: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least _____, his name”
    Key: legally

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What was Gatsby's real name?

    A. James Gatz

    B. Jay Cody

    C. Gus Gatz

    D. Jim Carraway

    Key: A (James Gatz)

87. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did Gatsby grow up?

    A. Chicago

B. Kentucky

C. North Dakota

D. New York

Key: C (North Dakota)

88. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The none too savoury _____ by which Ella Kaye, the newspaper woman, played Madame de Maintenon to his weakness and sent him to sea in a yacht, were common property of the turgid journalism in 1902." Word bank: volleying, debauchee, countered, ramifications

Key: ramifications

89. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He went out to the open _____ and sat down on a folding-chair, and the station slid away and the backs of unfamiliar buildings moved by." Word bank: scurried, vestibule, ravenously, amorphous

Key: vestibule

90. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comforts Wilson?

A. Michaelis

B. Catherine

C. Tom

D. Nick

Key: A (Michaelis)

91. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comes to the funeral?

A. Daisy

B. Hundreds

C. Tom

D. Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others

Key: D (Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others)

92. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would shortly be served up in racy pasquinade—but Catherine, who might have said anything, didn't say a…", what does "pasquinade" most nearly mean?

A. a mocking public piece of satire

B. a seaplane, an aircraft that can land on water

C. fragrant yellow flowers related to the daffodil

D. an untidy, disordered state

Key: A (a mocking public piece of satire)

93. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "And as the moon rose higher the inessential houses began to melt away until gradually I became aware of the old island here that flowered once for Dutch sailors' eyes—a fresh, green breast of the new world.", what does "inessential" most nearly mean?

A. hard to catch hold of or remember

B. in a pattern of bright, many-coloured diamonds or patches

C. a disappointing letdown after something exciting

D. not needed; unimportant

Key: D (not needed; unimportant)

94. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

95. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Daisy's tears over the shirts. The evidence is “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

96. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Nick's praise. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

97. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.
A. Illusion and reality
B. Class and money
C. The past and time
D. The American Dream

Key: B (Class and money)

98. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Nick's self-assessment. The evidence is “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “people” and “honest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

99. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153).
Sample answer: His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.". The evidence is “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), which shows the reason for everything. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

100. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IV”? Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville.
A. Conflict
B. Structure
C. Tone / mood

D. Metaphor

Key: B (Structure)

101. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. The evidence is “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words “orgiastic” and “believed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. The evidence is “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words “vulnerable” and “younger” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Can any real person match a five-year dream? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: the dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

104. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the American Dream dead at the end?

Sample answer: A reasoned view: the Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words “breast” and “green” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

106. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Now he was a sturdy straw-haired man of thirty, with a rather hard mouth and a supercilious manner.”, what does “supercilious” most nearly mean?

A. behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud

B. to confirm that something is true

C. in a showy, too-bright way

D. hard to catch hold of or remember

Key: A (behaving as if one is better than others; scornfully proud)

107. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “I remember the portrait of him up in Gatsby’s bedroom, a grey, florid man with a hard, empty face—the pioneer debauchee, who during one phase of American life brought back to the Eastern seaboard the savage violence of…”, what does “debauchee” most nearly mean?

A. brass wind instruments with a reed, central to 1920s jazz

B. the quality of giving off light; brightness

C. pale and lacking energy (British spelling of anemic)

D. a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures

Key: D (a man who lives for drink, sex and other pleasures)

108. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 7: “sprang from his Platonic _____ of himself”

Key: conception

109. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IX”?

A. Gatsby's party

B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

D. The reunion

Key: B (The funeral and the meaning of the dream)

110. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1).

Sample answer: Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

111. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The reason for everything. The evidence is “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words “across” and “bought” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

112. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Nick's birthday reflection. The evidence is “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words “loneliness” and “promise” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

113. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Wilson on the eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “everything” and “sees” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

114. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Gatsby dies still believing.

A. Class and money

B. The American Dream

C. The past and time

D. Illusion and reality

Key: B (The American Dream)

115. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Tom and Daisy are careless people.

A. The past and time

B. Carelessness and morality

C. Class and money

D. The American Dream

Key: B (Carelessness and morality)

116. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.

A. Theme

B. Metaphor

C. Characterization

D. Tone / mood

Key: C (Characterization)

117. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how the past and time develops from Chapter V to Chapter VI. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter V, paragraph 118, the text reads “They’re such beautiful shirts” — Daisy's tears over the shirts. In Chapter VI, “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) — Gatsby's real name. Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

118. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Gatsby's real name. The evidence is “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The words “legally” and “really” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

119. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Someone with a positive manner, perhaps a detective, used the expression ‘madman’ as he bent over Wilson’s body

that afternoon, and the _____ authority of his voice set the key for the newspaper reports next morning."

Word bank: pasquinade, adventitious, orgiastic, inessential

Key: adventitious

120. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Nick move West?

Sample answer: Disillusionment with the East: Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away. The evidence is "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us" (Chapter IX, paragraph 161).

121. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).

Sample answer: Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!". The evidence is "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) — Gatsby's real name. This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

122. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Old money defeats new money.

A. Illusion and reality

B. The American Dream

C. Class and money

D. The past and time

Key: C (Class and money)

123. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter VIII"? Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.

A. Characterization

B. Irony

C. Allusion

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Characterization)

124. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how the American Dream develops from Chapter III to Chapter IV. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter III, paragraph 1, the text reads "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars", which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. In Chapter IV, "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) — Gatsby's invented past. Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

125. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words "significance" and "vanished" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

126. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how the American Dream develops from Chapter IV to Chapter VIII. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter IV, paragraph 24, the text reads “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” — Gatsby's invented past. In Chapter VIII, “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) — Nick's verdict. Gatsby dies still believing.

127. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how carelessness and morality develops from Chapter VIII to Chapter IX. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter VIII, paragraph 45, the text reads “They’re a rotten crowd” — Nick's verdict. In Chapter IX, “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) — Nick's verdict. Tom and Daisy are careless people.

128. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153)

A. The dream shrinks when reached.

B. The reason for everything.

C. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

D. First image of the green light.

Key: B (The reason for everything.)

129. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Nick's praise meaningful?

Sample answer: He disapproved of Gatsby from beginning to end. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) — Nick's praise. This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing.

130. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104)

A. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.

B. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

C. Wilson on the eyes.

D. The dream shrinks when reached.

Key: C (Wilson on the eyes.)

131. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the pool suggest?

Sample answer: The end of summer and dream. The evidence is “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) — Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.

132. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162)

A. The reason for everything.

B. The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

C. Wilson on the eyes.

D. Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

Key: B (The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.)

133. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and

creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

134. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us" (Chapter IX, paragraph 161)

A. Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.

B. The dream shrinks when reached.

C. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

D. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

Key: A (Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.)

135. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "They're such beautiful shirts"

A. Chapter III

B. Chapter II

C. Chapter VI

D. Chapter V

Key: D (Chapter V)

136. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words "whisperings" and "champagne" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

137. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Gatsby's insight about Daisy. The evidence is "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words "voice" and "money" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

138. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) supports it: He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes. But "He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) complicates it: Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance, and it pulls the other way. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

139. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Nick's praise. The evidence is “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “together” and “whole” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

140. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who led Wilson to Gatsby?

Sample answer: Tom: Wilson on the eyes. The evidence is “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

141. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)

A. The dream shrinks when reached.

B. The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

C. The reason for everything.

D. Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.

Key: D (Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.)

142. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121).

Sample answer: Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.". The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached. This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

143. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Reality versus illusion. The evidence is “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “afternoon” and “tumbled” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

144. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. The evidence is “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118). This develops class and money: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. The words “beautiful” and “little” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.".

145. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is

drained of life. The words “valley” and “ashes” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

146. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The billboard eyes. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. The words “gigantic” and “blue” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

147. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Gatsby's charm. The evidence is “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. The words “reassurance” and “quality” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

148. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Wolfshiem. The evidence is “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words “fixed” and “back” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".

149. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Gatsby's invented past. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. The words “wealthy” and “people” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay.".

150. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Daisy's tears over the shirts. The evidence is “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". The words “beautiful” and “shirts” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick notes

that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

151. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Self-invention. The evidence is “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7). This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. The words “conception” and “himself” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!".

152. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Daisy's answer. The evidence is “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money. The words “loved” and “love” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

153. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. The words “rotten” and “crowd” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

154. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Nick's verdict. The evidence is “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). This develops carelessness and morality: Tom and Daisy are careless people. The words “creatures” and “retreated” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past.".

155. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152)

    A. Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.

    B. First image of the green light.

    C. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.

    D. Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

    Key: B (First image of the green light.)

156. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

B. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

C. Gatsby's death

D. James Gatz and the second party

Key: A (Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans)

157. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. The evidence is “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118).

158. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1)

A. Daisy's tears over the shirts.

B. The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

C. The final image: striving forward while the past keeps pulling us back.

D. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

Key: B (The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.)

159. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The billboard eyes. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

160. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why does Myrtle act grand at the apartment?

Sample answer: She performs the class she hopes Tom will give her. The evidence is “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127) — Tom's casual violence.

161. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why are Eckleburg's eyes described as watching the valley?

Sample answer: They suggest a god-like witness, or the absence of one. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

162. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What do the car wreck and Jordan's driving suggest?

Sample answer: Carelessness that will later kill: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

163. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why are the rumours about Gatsby so wild?

Sample answer: His mystery invites projection: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).

164. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why does the near-falling clock matter?
Sample answer: Gatsby tries to stop time; it is a symbol of the past. The evidence is "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached.

165. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? "I did love him once—but I loved you too" (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Daisy's answer. The evidence is "I did love him once—but I loved you too" (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). This develops class and money: old money defeats new money.

166. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "a fresh, green breast of the new world" (Chapter IX, paragraph 159)

A. Gatsby's insight about Daisy.

B. Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

C. Wilson on the eyes.

D. The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.

Key: D (The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.)

167. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

A. The past and time

B. The American Dream

C. Illusion and reality

D. Class and money

Key: D (Class and money)

168. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter II"? The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.

A. Hyperbole

B. Irony

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Setting

Key: D (Setting)

169. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter II"? Eckleburg's eyes 'brood on over the solemn dumping ground': a god-like witness who sees nothing.

A. Personification

B. Structure

C. Symbolism

D. Hyperbole

Key: C (Symbolism)

170. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars"

A. Chapter II

B. Chapter VII

C. Chapter III

D. Chapter VIII

Key: C (Chapter III)

171. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter III”? Gatsby's smile, ‘one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it,’ and his formal ‘old sport.’

A. Characterization

B. Symbolism

C. Allusion

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Characterization)

172. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Is Gatsby's party joyful or empty? Use details.

Sample answer: An evaluation of the imagery: the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

173. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Does Nick's claim 'I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known' convince you?

Sample answer: A reasoned judgment: Nick's self-assessment. The evidence is “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171). This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

174. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Is Gatsby's display of wealth love or performance?

Sample answer: An evaluation: the dream shrinks when reached. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121). This develops illusion and reality: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.". Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts.".

175. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Did Gatsby die for a dream or a lie?

Sample answer: A reasoned argument: Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. The evidence is “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110). This develops the American Dream: Gatsby dies still believing. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

176. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

A. Gatsby's death

B. Gatsby's party

C. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

D. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

Key: B (Gatsby's party)

177. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

A. Gatsby's death

B. The reunion

C. James Gatz and the second party

D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

Key: B (The reunion)

178. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Why does the green light lose its meaning?

Sample answer: Daisy is near; the symbol becomes an object. The evidence is “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), which shows the dream shrinks when reached.

179. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.

A. Conflict

B. Tone / mood

C. Alliteration

D. Structure

Key: D (Structure)

180. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money”

A. Chapter VII

B. Chapter VIII

C. Chapter IX

D. Chapter VI

Key: C (Chapter IX)

181. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how illusion and reality develops from Chapter III to Chapter V. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter III, paragraph 1, the text reads “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars”, which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. In Chapter V, “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) — Daisy's tears over the shirts. No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion.".

182. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Why does the narrator begin with his father's advice?

Sample answer: To present himself as fair and reserved, which the reader can then test. The evidence is “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1), which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

183. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What do the descriptions of East and West Egg suggest about class?

Sample answer: East Egg is older, more fashionable money; West Egg is new and showy. The evidence is “In my younger

and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1), which shows the opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.

184. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

B. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

C. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

D. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

Key: C (Gatsby's story and Daisy's past)

185. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" (Chapter V, paragraph 121)

A. The dream shrinks when reached.

B. Nick turns Gatsby's hope into everyone's: a future we chase that always moves away.

C. First image of the green light.

D. Wilson on the eyes.

Key: A (The dream shrinks when reached.)

186. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VI"?

A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

B. James Gatz and the second party

C. The reunion

D. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

Key: B (James Gatz and the second party)

187. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does Daisy dislike about West Egg?

Sample answer: Its raw vigor and lack of polish. The evidence is "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself" (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) — Self-invention. This develops the past and time: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

188. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Why does Gatsby insist on repeating the past?

Sample answer: He wants to recover himself as well as Daisy. The evidence is "Why of course you can" (Chapter VI, paragraph 129) — Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

189. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Why does Gatz's schedule matter?

Sample answer: It shows the boy's self-making: the Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. The evidence is "a fresh, green breast of the new world" (Chapter IX, paragraph 159).

190. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter III"? Gatsby's party in sensory overload: 'In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars.'

A. Foreshadowing

B. Hyperbole

C. Alliteration

D. Imagery

Key: D (Imagery)

191. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IV”? Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, ‘the man who fixed the World's Series,’ shows the criminal side of his world.

A. Imagery

B. Irony

C. Alliteration

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

192. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VI”? ‘his Platonic conception of himself’: an ideal self-creation.

A. Foreshadowing

B. Irony

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Hyperbole

Key: C (Diction / vocabulary)

193. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VI”? Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.

A. Allusion

B. Personification

C. Alliteration

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

194. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VII”? The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.

A. Setting

B. Metaphor

C. Personification

D. Hyperbole

Key: A (Setting)

195. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VII”? Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom.

A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Characterization

C. Tone / mood

D. Metaphor

Key: B (Characterization)

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Why does Nick stay at the party although he wants to leave?

Sample answer: His fascination and passivity: 'within and without'. The evidence is “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) — The billboard eyes. This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her

way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

197. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Is Myrtle a victim, a social climber, or both? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence: the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. The evidence is “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). This develops class and money: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

198. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?
A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream
B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans
C. James Gatz and the second party
D. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party
Key: D (The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party)

199. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] How does Jordan's story change our view of Gatsby?
Sample answer: His display becomes a romantic quest. The evidence is “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) — Gatsby's invented past.

200. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1).
Sample answer: Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them. The evidence is “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1), which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. This develops illusion and reality: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

201. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how illusion and reality develops from Chapter II to Chapter III. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Chapter II, paragraph 1, the text reads “This is a valley of ashes”, which shows the wasteland that wealth leaves behind. In Chapter III, “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1), which shows the party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 32, inference 9, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	51, 52, 6, 53, 54, 55, 8, 1, 3, 11, 56, 57, 58, 16, 22, 15, 59, 60, 19, 18, 61, 62, 26, 63, 64, 65, 30, 66, 67, 68, 31, 69, 35, 37, 36, 70, 71, 41, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 44, 77, 78, 79, 48, 80, 50	recall 31, inference 7, analysis 9, synthesis 3

HS Sophomore	81, 51, 54, 55, 82, 4, 83, 1, 6, 84, 53, 22, 85, 15, 16, 17, 86, 87, 88, 60, 18, 89, 90, 91, 65, 66, 92, 93, 30, 31, 94, 33, 35, 95, 37, 96, 72, 97, 98, 99, 100, 44, 79, 78, 101, 102, 103, 49, 104, 105	recall 30, inference 6, analysis 9, synthesis 5
HS Junior	3, 52, 106, 1, 6, 2, 8, 54, 84, 5, 60, 88, 87, 61, 20, 107, 59, 108, 15, 17, 64, 92, 32, 65, 31, 63, 91, 29, 30, 34, 69, 35, 38, 40, 71, 109, 42, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 48, 102, 117, 118, 50, 105	recall 29, inference 7, analysis 8, synthesis 6
HS Senior	4, 7, 53, 51, 84, 83, 6, 8, 55, 5, 81, 54, 86, 20, 87, 15, 107, 108, 88, 60, 16, 65, 119, 93, 68, 67, 63, 92, 64, 34, 95, 71, 120, 41, 42, 110, 111, 121, 122, 114, 123, 78, 116, 47, 124, 103, 125, 126, 50, 127	recall 29, inference 5, analysis 10, synthesis 6
AP	1, 5, 2, 53, 106, 8, 52, 6, 84, 55, 54, 51, 20, 21, 88, 60, 19, 87, 22, 32, 63, 31, 66, 93, 119, 33, 34, 128, 69, 35, 129, 130, 131, 71, 41, 132, 133, 134, 42, 110, 135, 121, 123, 114, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 126	recall 25, inference 13, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Freshman	55, 3, 6, 84, 8, 1, 106, 2, 51, 60, 87, 59, 15, 16, 17, 20, 61, 119, 64, 30, 92, 91, 31, 29, 67, 96, 141, 42, 111, 142, 143, 79, 78, 101, 144, 102, 145, 146, 147, 136, 148, 149, 150, 118, 151, 137, 152, 153, 105, 154	recall 25, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 16
College Sophomore	81, 2, 7, 5, 19, 92, 64, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 33, 162, 163, 69, 35, 164, 95, 165, 130, 141, 131, 129, 71, 134, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 99, 121, 112, 77, 123, 46, 145, 172, 173, 149, 174, 151, 140, 175, 138, 139	recall 7, inference 22, analysis 11, synthesis 10
College Junior	83, 1, 22, 21, 61, 92, 64, 159, 176, 162, 163, 177, 164, 178, 129, 131, 109, 166, 120, 42, 98, 171, 99, 142, 179, 76, 112, 114, 123, 113, 101, 180, 115, 144, 102, 145, 136, 147, 149, 148, 150, 181, 118, 151, 137, 152, 138, 139, 153, 175	recall 7, inference 12, analysis 14, synthesis 17
College Senior	83, 92, 182, 156, 183, 162, 176, 184, 178, 164, 185, 186, 187, 188, 129, 40, 166, 120, 189, 132, 42, 110, 97, 98, 190, 191, 111, 143, 179, 192, 45, 193, 194, 195, 78, 47, 180, 144, 102, 196, 197, 136, 173, 148, 149, 150, 118, 151, 152, 126	recall 2, inference 18, analysis 17, synthesis 13
Graduate / PhD	32, 161, 198, 162, 33, 163, 199, 95, 177, 164, 178, 187, 188, 40, 131, 96, 120, 189, 132, 109, 72, 43, 168, 169, 200, 171, 74, 99, 75, 143, 121, 45, 193, 192, 44, 112, 78, 101, 102, 144, 145, 201, 148, 125, 151, 137, 152, 153, 105, 154	recall 1, inference 19, analysis 18, synthesis 12

Final paper

The Great Gatsby: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the American Dream across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Great Gatsby and argue how its meaning changes over the novel and why that change matters to class and money.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Great Gatsby. Argue whether the novel judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Great Gatsby finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of the past and time. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the chapter and paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. The text makes this visible when it says “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152). He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away.". A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Critical voice: “The thing that chiefly interests the basic Fitzgerald is still the florid show of modern American life—and especially the devil's dance that goes on at the top.” (H. L. Mencken, critic and journalist, *Review of The Great Gatsby, Chicago Sunday Tribune (3 May 1925), reprinted as "Time Machine" (10 Oct 2014), middle paragraphs*; public domain). Thesis frame: if the novel's subject is "the devil's dance … at the top," is the American Dream its target or its victim? Test with Chapter III (the party) and the final page. *Objective:* Final paper Prompts 1 and 2: the American Dream, class and money. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1, W.11-12.9

Critical voice: “Of his uncompromising love-his love for Daisy Buchanan-his effort to recapture the past romance-we are explicitly informed.” (Edwin Clark, reviewer, *"Scott Fitzgerald Looks Into Middle Age," The New York Times Book Review (19 April 1925), review text*; public domain). Point-of-view lens: "explicitly informed" by whom? Nick. Students weigh "Can't repeat the past? … Why of course you can!" (Ch. VI) against the boats "borne back ceaselessly into the past." (Hyphens are the source's dashes.) *Objective:* Final paper Prompt 4: weigh whether the novel endorses or criticizes its society's view of the past and time. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, W.11-12.9

Essay assignments

Essay: The American Dream

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about the American Dream. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the American Dream across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the American Dream. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the American Dream, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of the American Dream in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the American Dream in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Class and money

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about class and money. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops class and money in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops class and money across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class and money. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class and money in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class and money, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of class and money in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class and money in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class and money in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class and money in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class and money in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The past and time

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about the past and time. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the past and time across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the past and time. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the past and time, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of the past and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the past and time in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the past and time in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the past and time in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Illusion and reality

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about illusion and reality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops illusion and reality across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of illusion and reality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of illusion and reality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of illusion and reality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Carelessness and morality

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about carelessness and morality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops carelessness and morality across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of carelessness and morality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of carelessness and morality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of carelessness and morality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified: short origin notes in our own words, with the facts (language, form, meaning) checked against the Online Etymology Dictionary or Wiktionary; no dictionary text is reproduced, and unverified ones are left out. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.

Built from curriculum-v5.9.2 (f0080de7).